

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Jainism - Learner-v2

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Jainism

English-first concept spine • Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows in parentheses

- 1 many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)
- 2 qualified assertion (syādvāda)
- 3 sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)
- 4 liberation (mokṣa)

Read the complete Markdown/PDF for arguments, objections, PYQs and model answers.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Jainism - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

Catalogue identity: Philosophy Optional · Philosophy Paper I - Indian Philosophy · philosophy-paper-i-indian-philosophy-02 **Generation:** g14, 29 August 2026 · **Approval:** pending explicit topic approval **Evidence discipline:** doctrine and PYQ wording/year/marks are controlled by repository owners. Model answers are independent pedagogic practice, never official UPSC keys.

Package practice counts

Component	Count
Direct verified topic-owned PYQs	9
Core diagnostic MCQs	40
Remedial diagnostic MCQs	8
Total diagnostics	48
Original solved Mains models	6 (2 × 10, 2 × 15, 2 × 20)
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L)
Approval	false

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Jainism

English-first concept spine • Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows in parentheses

- 1 many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)
- 2 qualified assertion (syādvāda)
- 3 sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)
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[Read the complete Markdown/PDF for arguments, objections, PYQs and model answers.](#)

Jainism English-first concept spine

Concept spine: English concepts lead; Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows immediately.

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Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

Source corpus	Final location	Retention decision
Layered Simple/Core/Exam/Rapid material	Basic Learning Session	Complete seven-subtopic teaching sequence retained
Layered Advanced material	Optional Advanced	Every advanced synthesis retained after practice
Canonical owner	Reconciled through layered session	Full metaphysics, epistemology, judgement and soteriology ownership retained
Legacy solved workbook	PYQs and Answer Practice	Nine solved PYQs preserved and improved
Premium diagnostic replacement	MCQs / Remediation	Legacy 24+8 set expanded to genuine 40+8 with strict rotation
Original practice	PYQs and Answer Practice	Six solved non-PYQ models replace the legacy three-model set
Consolidated register	Final section	A-L retrieval framework covers all printed syllabus limbs

Answer-worthiness. Theory of reality, *many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)*, *substance (dravya)-quality (guṇa)-mode (paryāya)*, *sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)*, material action and moral consequence (karma), bondage and liberation are **CORE SYLLABUS**. The Jaina means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) scheme, seven *nayas*, action and moral consequence (karma) taxonomy and *guṇasthānas* are **CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH** where they explain PYQs. Sectarian minutiae and unverified legal detail are not answer targets.

SESSION 1 - JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jainism is a liberation-centred realist philosophy that explains finite knowledge, karmic bondage and freedom through a many-sided account of reality.

Technical definition: Jain philosophy combines pluralistic realism, many-sided reality (anekāntavāda), standpoint-conditioned predication and a material theory of action and moral consequence (karma) within one soteriological system.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism links ontology, epistemology and ethics: reality has many aspects, finite judgments are standpoint-bound, and disciplined conduct removes material karmic bondage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Jina
- conscious soul (jīva)
- non-conscious reality (ajīva)
- many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)
- three jewels (ratnatraya)
- liberation (mokṣa)

How to use them: Introduce Jainism as a plural realist and liberation-oriented system, then connect its ontology of souls and non-souls to epistemic humility and disciplined conduct.

FACT: A live August 2026 search primarily returned contemporary educational discussion of *many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)* and continuing ethical discussion of *sallekhanā*, not a clearly verified new court ruling in the February-August window. **ANALYSIS: Inference:** Use *many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)* as a conceptual resource for intellectual humility and *sallekhanā* as a bounded ethics application. Do not invent a fresh legal development or let

current application replace the printed metaphysics-logic-liberation syllabus.

Doctrine	Level	One-line role
<i>Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)</i>	metaphysics	reality has many objective aspects
<i>Standpoint analysis (nayavāda)</i>	epistemology	finite knowledge grasps a standpoint
<i>Qualified assertion (syādvāda)</i>	semantics	assertions require conditional qualification
<i>Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)</i>	formal expansion	seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility

Master verdict: Jainism is pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism and a material theory of karmic bondage; its unity lies in linking ontology, knowledge, conduct and liberation.

How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

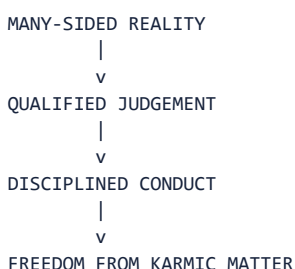
Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the repository Jainism knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 PYQ bank were checked; local OCR-searchable chapters in Chatterjee-Datta and C. D. Sharma were directly inspected. A live 2026 search found contemporary discussion of *many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)* and *sallekhanā*, used only as labelled conceptual application rather than doctrinal authority. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the previous complete Jainism session is retained below. The new material provides simpler gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing the original depth.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the three connected pillars



In simple words: Jainism is one connected philosophical system. Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

First anchor	Easy meaning
<i>Tattvārthasūtra</i>	Shared systematic text for the major Jaina traditions
Three jewels	Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct
Tirthaṅkara	Liberated teacher and ford-maker, not a creator God
Central movement	Reality -> knowledge -> conduct -> liberation

Memory line: Jainism joins realism, intellectual humility and self-purification.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

ONE-SCREEN MAP

JAINISM

- + SOURCE ANCHOR
 - + Tattvārthasūtra: ratna-traya, principles (tattvas), substance (dravyas), knowledge (jñāna), liberation
- + THEORY OF REALITY
 - + Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda): reality is many-sided
 - + Substance (dravya) = sat = utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya
 - + Six substance (dravyas): conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla
 - + Pañcāstikāya: five extended substances; kāla is an-astikāya
 - + Quality (guṇa) (qualities) + mode (paryāya) (modes)
- + EPISTEMOLOGY
 - + Perception (pratyakṣa) vs parokṣa, with the Jaina inversion trap
 - + Five jñānas: mati, śruta, avadhi, mañhāparyāya, kevala
 - + Partial kṣāyopāśamika knowledge grounds standpoint analysis (nayavāda) and qualified assertion (syādvāda)
- + THEORY OF JUDGEMENT
 - + Standpoint analysis (nayavāda): partial standpoints
 - + Qualified assertion (syādvāda): conditional predication
 - + Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī): sevenfold judgement
- + SOTERIOLOGY
 - + Seven principles (tattvas) / nine categories (padārthas)
 - + Action and moral consequence (karma) = subtle material pudgala; eight karma-prakṛtis
 - + Influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa)
 - + Bhāva-bandha + dravya-bandha; four bandha-parameters
 - + Guṇasthānas: fourteen stages, including sayoga-kevalī
 - + Three jewels + vows + sallekhanā lead to perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) and liberation

0A. UMĀSVĀTĪ / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA FACT:

Statement. FACT: The *Tattvārthasūtra* or *Tattvārthahigama-sūtra* of **Umāsvāti** in Śvetāmbara usage and **Umāsvāmī** in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: It gives a compact doctrinal grammar for Jaina metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, bondage, and liberation.
2. FACT: Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.
3. FACT: It states the path through the **ratna-traya** (three jewels): **samyag-darśana** (right vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyak-cāritra** (right conduct).
4. FACT: It systematizes the seven principles (tattvas), the five astikāyas plus kāla, and the classification of knowledge (jñāna) without reducing Jainism to only ethics or only logic.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

Distinction. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers and ford-makers, not creator Gods; Jainism remains **anīśvaravāda** (non-theistic about creation).

Example. FACT: The famous formulation that right vision, right knowledge, and right conduct together constitute the path to liberation (mokṣa) may be safely used without inventing a sūtra number.

Objection (sectarian-history objection). CAUTION: A critic may ask whether a text accepted by both Śvetāmbaras and Digambaras erases real sectarian differences.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It does not erase them; it supplies a shared doctrinal framework within which disagreements about canon, practice, and interpretation can still remain.

Names to drop carefully. FACT:

- FACT: **Kundakunda:** Digambara thinker associated with *Samayasāra* and the **niścaya-naya / vyavahāra-naya** distinction.
- FACT: **Siddhasena Divākara** and **Samantabhadra:** important names in the early logic of many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) and qualified assertion (syādvāda).
- FACT: **Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra,** and **Yaśovijaya:** major later Jaina logicians to cite for the mature means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) tradition.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- Use this system map as the introduction to any 15- or 20-marker.
- A high-scoring opening states that Jainism is **pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage.**
- Do not spend more than two or three lines on sectarian history unless the question specifically asks for sources.
- The nine verified topic-owned PYQs are solved in the complete practice section and separate workbook.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Textual anchor: Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī and the *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Path: *samyag-darśana* + *samyag-jñāna* + *samyak-cāritra*.
- No creator God; liberated teachers remain numerically distinct souls.
- Never reduce Jainism to either "seven viewpoints" or "non-violence" alone.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - permanence without freezing change

GOLD BRACELET
|
| reshaped
v
GOLD RING

gold persists = dhrauvya
bracelet-mode ends = vyaya
ring-mode begins = utpada

In simple words: a real thing can remain the same substance while its modes change. Jainism refuses both extremes: reality is neither a motionless block nor a series with no enduring identity.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>Substance (dravya)</i>	Enduring substance
<i>Quality (guṇa)</i>	Stable quality belonging to it
<i>Mode (paryāya)</i>	Changing mode or condition
<i>Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)</i>	A real has many objective aspects
<i>Six substance (dravyas)</i>	Soul, matter, motion-medium, rest-medium, space and time

Memory line: the substance persists while modes originate and decay.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Jina · conscious soul (jīva) · non-conscious reality (ajīva) ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Conscious soul (jīva) becomes bound when passions attract karmic matter,	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Liberation requires both epistemic non-absolutism and rigorous ethical	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not reduce many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) to relativism, because
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism links ontology, epistemology and ethics: reality has many			

SESSION 2 - CONSCIOUS SOUL (jīva), NON-CONSCIOUS REALITY (ajīva), SUBSTANCE (dravya), QUALITY (guṇa) AND MODE (paryāya)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Distinction. FACT: Quality (guṇa) is not the same as mode (paryāya): qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Technical definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring substance (dravya) possesses quality (guṇa) (qualities) and changing mode (paryāya) (modes).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring substance (dravya) possesses quality (guṇa) (qualities) and changing mode (paryāya) (modes).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **conscious soul (jīva)**
- **non-conscious reality (ajīva)**
- **substance (dravya)**
- **quality (guṇa)**
- **mode (paryāya)**
- **persistence-through-change**

How to use them: Use substance (dravya), quality (guṇa) and mode (paryāya) to explain how a real substance persists through changing modes without becoming either absolutely permanent or merely momentary.

CORE DEFINITION: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring substance (dravya) possesses quality (guṇa) (qualities) and changing mode (paryāya) (modes).

1.1 Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) as metaphysical thesis

Statement. FACT: **Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)** is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

Argument. FACT:

1. Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.
2. Human cognition usually grasps only one aspect at a time.
3. Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.
4. A sound metaphysics must allow plurality of aspects within one real.
5. Hence reality is non-one-sided, or many-sided reality (anekāntavāda).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Being is richer than any single finite judgement.

Distinction. FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is not mere indecision. It is a **metaphysical** claim about the complexity of reality, not yet the logical form of predication.

Example. FACT: A jar is permanent as a substance across a short stretch, changing in modes, describable by shape, use, material, and temporal state. No one predicate says all of this at once.

Objection (skeptical objection). FACT: If every object has indefinitely many aspects, knowledge may become impossible.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thought replies that knowledge is possible precisely through qualified standpoints, not through absolutist simplification.

1.2 Substance (dravya) as sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya FACT:

Statement. FACT: The real (**sat**) is what possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay), and **dhrauvya** (persistence or permanence) together.

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience shows change: forms arise and pass.
2. Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.
3. Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.
4. Pure flux cannot explain identity.
5. Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.
6. This is articulated by saying substance is characterized by origination, decay, and permanence.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Both common-sense identity and experiential change are philosophically significant and must be preserved.

Distinction. FACT: This differs from Buddhist momentariness, which gives primacy to flux, and from strict monisms that absorb change into mere appearance.

Example. FACT: A gold ornament changes from bracelet to ring: modes originate and cease, yet the underlying substance persists.

Objection (Buddhist/Nyāya-style objection). FACT: How can opposite features-change and permanence-belong to one thing?

Reply. FACT: They belong in different respects: permanence as substance (dravya), change as mode (paryāya).

1.3 Six substance (dravyas) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically recognizes **six substance (dravyas)**: **conscious soul (jīva)**, **pudgala**, **dharma**, **adharma**, **ākāśa**, and **kāla**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The classification accounts for consciousness, matter, motion, rest, spatial accommodation, and temporal succession.
2. FACT: Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each substance (dravya) has a distinct explanatory function.
3. FACT: Five of the six substance (dravyas) are **astikāyas** (extended substances with many space-points or **pradeśas**).
4. FACT: **Kāla** (time) is a real substance (dravya) in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is **not** an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of **pañcāstikāya** plus **kāla**.

The six substance (dravyas). FACT:

Substance (dravya)	Basic sense	Role
Conscious soul (jīva)	conscious substance	experiencer, knower, bearer of bondage and liberation
Pudgala	matter	corporeality, karmic matter, bodies, sense-objects
Dharma	medium of motion	condition making movement possible

Substance (dravya)	Basic sense	Role
Adharma	medium of rest	condition making rest possible
Ākāśa	space	accommodation for substances
Kāla	time	succession, change, sequence

Astikāya table. FACT:

Substance (dravya)	Astikāya?	Function	Extension
Conscious soul (jīva)	FACT: Yes	knowing, experiencing, agency, bondage and liberation	FACT: Has pradeśas; in embodied existence it is co-extensive with the body
Pudgala	FACT: Yes	material bodies, sense-objects, speech, breath, karma-pudgala	FACT: Extended and aggregative
Dharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling motion	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Adharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling rest	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Ākāśa	FACT: Yes	gives room or accommodation to substances	FACT: Extended as lokākāśa and alokākāśa
Kāla	WRONG: No	succession, duration, before-and-after, change	FACT: A substance (dravya) but an-astikāya because it lacks spatial extension across many pradeśas in the astikāya sense

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Reality is irreducibly pluralistic, and extension must be distinguished from substantiality.

Distinction. FACT: **Dharma** and **adharma** here do **not** mean moral merit and demerit; they mean media of motion and rest.

Sectarian note. FACT: The safe doctrinal point is: **kāla is a substance (dravya) but not an astikāya**; the pañcāstikāya list has five members, while the substance (dravya) list has six. **CAUTION:** A common sectarian nuance is that Digambara authors characteristically affirm real **kāla-aṇus** (time-atoms) associated with the space-points of lokākāśa, whereas some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of kāla as disputed or conventional.

Example. FACT: A fish swims because water is the medium enabling motion; analogically, dharma-dravya is the cosmic condition enabling movement, not motion itself.

Objection (Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika-style objection). FACT: Dharma and adharma as “media” look mysterious and unparsimonious.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina metaphysics treats them not as pushes or forces but as enabling conditions required for a coherent pluralistic cosmology.

1.4 Quality (guṇa) and mode (paryāya) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every substance (dravya) possesses **quality (guṇa)** (essential qualities) and **mode (paryāya)** (modes or modifications).

Argument. FACT:

1. A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.
2. It must also undergo modal change or it would not participate in experience.
3. Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ontology must distinguish what remains from how it appears or changes.

Distinction. FACT: **Quality (guṇa)** is not the same as **mode (paryāya)**: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Example. FACT: Consciousness is a defining feature of conscious soul (jīva); pleasure, pain, delusion, or liberated omniscience are modes or conditions in which the conscious soul (jīva) appears.

Objection (Buddhist nominalist objection). FACT: Why not just speak of changing qualities rather than introduce a substance?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Because changing qualities still presuppose something whose changes they are.

1.5 Conscious soul (jīva) and non-conscious reality (ajīva) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The most fundamental ontological distinction is between **conscious soul (jīva)** (conscious) and **non-conscious reality (ajīva)** (non-conscious).

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience distinguishes living, aware beings from inert entities.
2. This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.
3. Hence the universe divides into conscious soul (jīva) and non-conscious reality (ajīva).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Consciousness is real and fundamental, not epiphenomenal.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman. Unlike Cārvāka, consciousness is not reducible to material organization.

Example. FACT: The body, speech, and even karmic matter belong to non-conscious reality (ajīva); the conscious experiencer bound by them is conscious soul (jīva).

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: If conscious soul (jīva) is immaterial, how can material action and moral consequence (karma) affect it?

Reply. ANALYSIS: This becomes the central challenge in Jaina bondage theory and is answered through the doctrine of karmic influx and adhesion, though critics find the relation obscure.

1.6 Nature of conscious soul (jīva) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every conscious soul (jīva) is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by action and moral consequence (karma).

Argument. FACT:

1. Liberation is meaningful only if the soul has a native capacity to realize perfection.
2. Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.
3. Therefore conscious soul (jīva) is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress presupposes a real self capable of purification.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is pluralistic: there are many conscious soul (jīvas), not one universal self. It also differs from Nyāya, where the self is conscious through conjunction with mind; in Jainism consciousness belongs intrinsically to conscious soul (jīva).

Example. FACT: Souls are graded from one-sense beings to five-sense beings; even minute living entities are morally significant.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is naturally omniscient, ignorance becomes hard to explain.

Reply. FACT: Action and moral consequence (karma) as obscuring matter is introduced precisely to explain the discrepancy between intrinsic capacity and empirical limitation.

1.7 Pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Pudgala** is the material substance (dravya) and the only substance (dravya) possessing **rūpa** (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

Argument. FACT:

1. Corporeality, extension, and sensible quality require a material substrate.
2. Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.
3. Since karmic bondage has quasi-physical efficacy, karmic particles too are classed under pudgala.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

Distinction. FACT: Pudgala is uniquely important because unlike conscious soul (jīva) it is divisible, aggregative, and form-bearing.

Example. FACT: The body I inhabit, the food I consume, the dust in air, and karmic accretions all belong to pudgala.

Objection (Nyāya/Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: To call action and moral consequence (karma) matter seems strange.

Reply. FACT: That strangeness is also Jainism's originality: bondage is not merely moral description but a real quasi-physical entanglement.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2019, Q6(a), 20 marks: define reality through *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*, explain *dravya-guṇa-paryāya*, then show how this ontology requires qualified judgement.

2025, Q7(c), 15 marks: establish realism through mind-independent substances and pluralism through the six *substance (dravyas)* and many individual souls; then evaluate objections.

For comparison answers, use one axis at a time: permanence/change, number of ultimate realities, status of difference, self, and liberation.

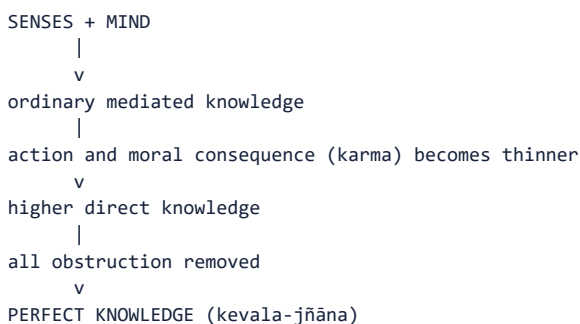
LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- *Sat* = origination + decay + permanence.
- Six *substance (dravyas)*; five are *astikāyas*, while *kāla* is a substance (*dravya*) but not an *astikāya*.
- *Dharma* and *adharma* mean media of motion and rest, not merit and sin.
- *Conscious soul (jīva)* is intrinsically conscious; *pudgala* alone possesses form and includes karmic matter.
- Trap: many-sided reality is objective pluralism, not subjective relativism.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - why ordinary seeing is not the highest direct knowledge



In simple words: Jainism calls the soul's unmediated cognition truly direct. Ordinary perception depends on senses and mind, so it is direct only in everyday usage. As karmic obstruction decreases, wider forms of knowledge become possible.

Knowledge	Simple role
<i>Mati</i>	Sense-and-mind cognition
<i>Śruta</i>	Verbal or scriptural cognition
<i>Avadhi</i>	Limited direct knowledge beyond ordinary senses
<i>Manahparyāya</i>	Direct cognition of mental states
<i>Kevala</i>	Complete unobstructed knowledge

Memory line: knowledge is intrinsic to the soul but limited by karmic obstruction.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CONSCIOUS SOUL (jīva), NON-CONSCIOUS REALITY (ajīva), SUBSTANCE (dravya), QUALITY (guṇa) AND MODE (paryāya)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | CONSCIOUS SOUL (jīva), NON-CONSCIOUS REALITY (ajīva), SUBSTANCE (dravya), QUALITY

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

conscious soul (jīva) · non-conscious reality (ajīva) · substance

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. FACT: Quality (guṇa) is not the same as mode (paryāya):

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Six substance (dravyas); five are astikāyas, while kāla is a substance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is

SESSION 3 - MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa), KNOWLEDGE AND MANY-SIDED REALITY (anekāntavāda)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Technical definition: Jaina epistemology distinguishes ultimately direct, soul-mediated knowledge from ordinary mediated cognition and explains finite judgments through the many-sidedness of their objects.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is not a free-standing logical device; it follows from a realist metaphysics in which finite knowers apprehend only limited aspects of complex objects.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- direct knowledge (pratyakṣa)
- mediated knowledge (parokṣa)
- many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)
- finite knower
- perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)
- karmic obstruction

How to use them: Derive perspectival human knowledge from many-sided reality and karmic limitation, while preserving perfect knowledge as the limiting case that prevents scepticism.

1A.1 Primary division: perception (pratyakṣa) and parokṣa FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology distinguishes **perception (pratyakṣa)** (direct knowledge) and **parokṣa** (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word perception (pratyakṣa) in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, **perception (pratyakṣa)** means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.
2. FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only **sāmvyavahārika perception (pratyakṣa)** (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).
3. FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and karmic limitation.
4. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Directness is measured by freedom from mediation and karmic obstruction, not merely by sensory vividness.

Distinction. FACT: Do not map Jaina perception (pratyakṣa) mechanically onto Nyāya perception (pratyakṣa); the same term carries a different doctrinal weight.

Example. FACT: Seeing a pot with the eyes is conventionally direct in ordinary dealings, but **perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** is direct in the strict spiritual sense.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya may object that perception through sense-contact is the paradigm of direct cognition.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that sense-contact is direct only pragmatically; metaphysically it is mediated by organs, mind, and knowledge-obscuring action and moral consequence (karma).

1A.2 Five kinds of knowledge (jñāna) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of knowledge (jñāna): **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Knowledge (jñāna)	Status	Meaning	UPSC trap
Mati-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa / conventional	sense-and-mind cognition	FACT: Ordinary perception is not strict perception (pratyakṣa)
Śruta-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa	scriptural, verbal, or sign-mediated knowledge derived from mati	FACT: Not blind faith; it depends on cognition and communication
Avadhi-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika perception (pratyakṣa)	limited clairvoyant direct knowledge of material things	FACT: Direct but limited
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika perception (pratyakṣa)	direct knowledge of others' mental modes	FACT: Higher than avadhi, still not omniscience
Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika perception (pratyakṣa)	unlimited, unmediated omniscience	FACT: The full overcoming of cognitive obstruction

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.
2. FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala are direct because the soul knows without ordinary sense-and-mind mediation.
3. FACT: The series shows graded release from karmic veiling.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.

Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

Example. FACT: A student's study of doctrine uses mati and śruta; the kevalin's omniscience is immediate and total.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala appear unverifiable to ordinary experience.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism treats them as necessary consequences of its soul-karma theory; a critic may still reject them if the ontology of conscious soul (jīva) and karmic obstruction is denied.

1A.3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna under mithyā-darśana FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism recognizes **mati-ajñāna** or **kumati**, **śruta-ajñāna** or **kuśruta**, and **vibhaṅga-jñāna** as wrong cognition.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.
2. FACT: Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under **mithyā-darśana** (false vision or wrong orientation).
3. FACT: **Kumati** is misoriented sensory-mental cognition; **kuśruta** is misoriented verbal or scriptural cognition; **vibhaṅga-jñāna** is perverted avadhi.
4. ANALYSIS: The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Epistemology and ethics interpenetrate: how one is disposed affects how one knows.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina error is not only logical mistake; it can be a karmically conditioned mode of seeing.

Example. FACT: A learned person may quote doctrine but use it for pride, sectarian contempt, or violence; the verbal cognition then functions as kuśruta.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Calling cognition wrong because of spiritual orientation seems to confuse truth with moral psychology.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that bondage affects the knower as a whole; epistemic correctness without right vision remains incomplete for liberation.

1A.4 Later Jaina logic and indirect means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) ANALYSIS:

Statement. FACT: Jainism admits inference (anumāna) and **verbal testimony (śabda)** (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.

Argument. ANALYSIS:

1. FACT: **Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, and Yaśovijaya** are important names for the developed Jaina means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) tradition.
2. ANALYSIS: Later Jaina logicians accept **smṛti** (recollection), **pratyabhijñā** (recognition), **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** or **ūha** (reasoning that grasps pervasion or vyāpti), and **inference (anumāna)** as valid indirect knowledge in appropriate contexts.
3. FACT: This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
4. ANALYSIS: The Jaina move protects continuity, recognition, and inferential preparation as genuine cognitive achievements without making them omniscient knowledge.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Valid cognition need not be restricted to fresh sense-contact; mediated cognition can still disclose real features of the object.

Distinction. FACT: **Verbal testimony (śabda)** is accepted as mediated knowledge, not as a creator-God's revelation; Jainism remains non-theistic about cosmic creation.

Example. FACT: Recognizing "this is the same teacher I met earlier" is not mere raw perception; it involves memory and recognition.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely reproduces past knowledge and is not a new means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that recollection and recognition can be valid cognition when they successfully connect present awareness with a real object or past experience.

1A.5 Critical link: means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) -> standpoint analysis (nayavāda) -> qualified assertion (syādvāda) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Reality is **ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu**: the real object has infinitely many aspects, properties, and modes.
2. FACT: Ordinary human cognition is **kṣāyopaśamika** (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and is therefore necessarily partial.
3. FACT: A judgment made by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole object.
4. FACT: A partial judgment is true only relative to its standpoint; this is **standpoint analysis (nayavāda)**.
5. FACT: Absolutising a partial standpoint yields **ekāntavāda** (one-sidedness), the root error of rival schools according to Jainism.
6. FACT: Therefore assertion must carry the operator **syāt** ("from a certain standpoint"); this is **qualified assertion (syādvāda)**.
7. FACT: The sevenfold schema of qualified predication is the disciplined expression of that standpoint-relativity; this is **sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)**.

8. FACT: Only **perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** grasps all aspects at once, because only omniscience is no longer karmically partial.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Finite cognition is not false simply because it is partial; it becomes false when it claims unconditioned finality.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina relativity is not subjectivism: the aspects are really in the object, but finite knowers access them partially.

Example. FACT: "The jar exists" is true with respect to its present substance-mode-place-time complex, but false with respect to another place, another time, or another incompatible mode.

Objection (Śaṃkara-style objection). FACT: If all assertions are standpoint-relative, the assertion of standpoint-relativity may also lose absolute force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts reflexive qualification: qualified assertion (syādvāda) too is asserted **syāt**, and its force lies in disciplined anti-absolutism rather than in an unqualified dogma.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The epistemology is essential to the **2023, Q5(a), 10 marks** quotation on empirical and relative knowledge. Test the quotation rather than accepting it: ordinary embodied cognition is relative, but Jainism admits non-sensory direct knowledge and *perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)*.

In a 15-marker, move through: classification of knowledge -> karmic limitation -> partial standpoints -> conditional predication -> omniscience qualification -> critical burden.

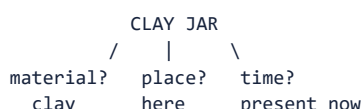
LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Strict Jaina *perception (pratyakṣa)* is soul-direct, not ordinary sense perception.
- *Mati* and *śruta* are ordinary mediated cognition.
- *Avadhi*, *manaḥpariyāya* and *kevala* are increasingly direct.
- Partial knowledge explains *naya*; it does not make external reality subjective.
- Trap: "all Jaina knowledge is empirical and relative" is false because of *perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)*.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - one object, several valid questions



"It exists" is incomplete until the respect is stated.

In simple words: the same jar can exist here, fail to exist elsewhere, persist as clay, and change as a particular shape. Jainism asks us to attach the hidden condition to every claim rather than turning one partial truth into the whole truth.

Doctrine	Job
<i>Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)</i>	Reality has many aspects
<i>Standpoint analysis (nayavāda)</i>	A judgement selects a partial standpoint
<i>Qualified assertion (syādvāda)</i>	The assertion is explicitly qualified
<i>Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)</i>	Seven ordered combinations of is, is-not and inexpressible

Memory line: many-sided object -> partial standpoint -> conditional sentence -> sevenfold expansion.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa), KNOWLEDGE AND MANY-SIDED REALITY (anekāntavāda)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa), KNOWLEDGE AND MANY-SIDED REALITY (anekāntavāda)			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS direct knowledge (pratyakṣa) · mediated knowledge (parokṣa) ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Jaina epistemology distinguishes ultimately direct, soul-mediated	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent means of valid	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is not a free-standing logical			

SESSION 4 - STANDPOINT ANALYSIS (nayavāda), QUALIFIED ASSERTION (syādvāda) AND SEVENFOLD PREDICATION (saptabhaṅgī)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

Technical definition: Statement. FACT: Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a naya, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) systematises conditional assertion by combining affirmation, negation and inexpressibility without attributing contradictions in the same respect.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- standpoint analysis (nayavāda)
- qualified assertion (syādvāda)
- sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)
- conditionality (syāt)
- inexpressibility (avaktavya)
- non-contradiction

How to use them: Move from a partial standpoint to a qualified proposition and then to the seven predicative possibilities, stressing that contrary claims are indexed to different conditions.

EXAM-READY LINE: sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) expresses qualified assertion (syādvāda) (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

2.1 Standpoint analysis (nayavāda): standpoint-theory

Statement. FACT: **Standpoint analysis (nayavāda)** teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a **naya**, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

Argument. FACT:

1. Reality is many-sided.
2. Finite knowers rarely grasp all sides at once.
3. Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.
4. A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Partiality is not falsehood; it becomes falsehood only when the partial is absolutized.

Distinction. FACT: Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) is not skepticism. It permits truth, but qualified truth.

Example. FACT: A jar may be described as clay, as container, as round, as breakable, as existing-now. Each statement is true from a standpoint.

Objection (Nyāya-style objection). FACT: Standpoints may proliferate without limit.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thinkers classify principal standpoints to discipline rather than dissolve discourse.

2.2 The seven nayas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Classical Jainism enumerates **seven nayas**, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

Naya	Brief meaning
Naigama naya	common or teleological standpoint; mixed, unspecialized practical view
Samgraha naya	generic standpoint; emphasis on class-character
Vyavahāra naya	practical or particular standpoint; ordinary usage about specific things
Rjusūtra naya	momentary or present-state standpoint
Verbal testimony (śabda) naya	verbal standpoint; attention to linguistic expression
Samabhirūḍha naya	etymological or strictly differentiated verbal standpoint
Evambhūta naya	actuality-conditioned verbal standpoint; a term applies when the function is being performed

Argument. FACT: The list shows that partiality may arise from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal, and linguistic conditioning.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse **nayas** (standpoints) with the **sevenfold predications** of qualified assertion (syādvāda). The former are epistemic perspectives; the latter are structured propositional forms.

Example. FACT: Calling a person “a singer” may be true generically or dispositionally, but **evambhūta naya** is stricter: the term applies in the relevant performance-actuality.

Objection (examiner's objection). FACT: The linguistic nayas seem overly scholastic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

2.3 Qualified assertion (syādvāda) as logical expression

Statement. FACT: **Qualified assertion (syādvāda)** is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification **syāt**—“in some respect,” “from a certain standpoint,” or “conditionally.”

Argument. FACT:

1. Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.
2. Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.
3. The particle **syāt** prevents absolutization.
4. Hence qualified assertion (syādvāda) is the logical-linguistic expression of many-sided reality (anekāntavāda).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Good logic mirrors ontological complexity and epistemic modesty.

Distinction. FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = metaphysical doctrine; standpoint analysis (naya-vāda) = theory of standpoints; qualified assertion (syādvāda) = mode of conditional predication.

Example. FACT: “The jar exists” becomes “syād asti”—it exists in some respect, e.g., as present on the floor now.

Objection (Śaṅkara-style objection). FACT: Constant qualification may weaken assertoric force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina logic accepts that precision is preferable to dogmatic simplicity.

2.4 Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī): the seven predications, exactly and in order FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)** is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier **syāt**.

1. **syād asti** - in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti** - in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca** - in some respect, it is and it is not.
4. **syād avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is indescribable.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is and is indescribable.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is, is not, and is indescribable.

Argument. FACT:

1. A thing may be affirmed under one standpoint.
2. Negated under another.
3. Both affirmed and negated under different references or times.
4. Called indescribable where simultaneous exhaustive predication fails.
5. Combinations of these yield seven basic structured forms.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Contraries need not violate logic when they are indexed to standpoint, time, relation, or mode.

Distinction. FACT: “Indescribable” does not mean mystical silence simpliciter. It means that an unqualified or simultaneous statement is not straightforwardly expressible.

Example. FACT: A clay jar exists now on the table; it does not exist as a lump of raw clay; it both is and is not under different modal descriptions; in a complex state of transition it may be called avaktavya.

Objection (Śaṃkara/Rāmānuja objection). FACT: Critics say this violates non-contradiction.

Reply. FACT: The Jaina response is that contradiction would arise only if affirmation and negation were made in the same respect at the same time in the same sense. Syāt blocks that absolutist reading.

2.5 Blind men and the elephant FACT:

Statement. FACT: The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of many-sided reality (anekāntavāda): each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.

Argument. ANALYSIS: The illustration dramatizes the difference between **partial correctness** and **exclusive completeness**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

Distinction. FACT: The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.

Example. FACT: One touches the trunk and says “the elephant is like a serpent,” another the leg and says “like a pillar.” Each is conditionally right and absolutely wrong.

Objection (pedagogical objection). FACT: The parable may trivialize complex metaphysics.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It is pedagogical, not probative; its use is to clarify the structure of partial truth.

2.6 Five kinds of knowledge FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of **five kinds of knowledge**: **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Kind of knowledge	Basic sense
Mati-jñāna	sensory-mental cognition, ordinary empirical knowledge
Śruta-jñāna	scriptural/verbal knowledge, mediated through signs and teaching
Avadhi-jñāna	clairvoyant knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sense range
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	telepathic knowledge of mental states
Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)	perfect omniscience

Argument. FACT: The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with the seven nayas or the sevenfold predications.

Example. FACT: The ordinary learner begins with mati and śruta, while the liberated or near-liberated soul culminates in perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna).

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Higher forms seem unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jainism they are internally connected to the ontology of soul and action and moral consequence (karma); externally they remain open to critical challenge.

2.7 Standard objection: is many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) self-refuting or trivial? FACT:

Statement. FACT: Critics argue either that many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is self-refuting-because the claim that "all reality is many-sided" is itself made absolutely-or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. If every assertion must be qualified, then the doctrine itself must be qualified.
2. If qualified, it may lose universal force.
3. If unqualified, it violates its own rule.
4. Alternatively, if it merely says that things can be looked at in different ways, it seems philosophically thin.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A doctrine of relativity must explain its own status.

Reply. FACT:

1. Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.
2. This does not collapse it; it exhibits the very discipline it teaches.
3. The thesis is not that all statements are equally true, but that truth is aspect-conditioned.
4. Its philosophical bite lies in reconciling plurality with realism, not in banal relativism.

2.8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) covertly presupposes absolutism.

Argument of the challenge. FACT:

1. The doctrine claims universal scope.
2. Universal scope appears absolute.
3. Therefore the doctrine seems to rely on the very absolutism it criticizes.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.
2. The doctrine is a methodological and ontological caution against ekānta, not a ban on all graded comprehensiveness.
3. Within Jainism, **perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** represents total knowledge, while ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound.
4. Hence the charge succeeds only if one confuses finite judgement with omniscient cognition.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: This is a subtle and strong reply: Jainism can admit a difference between omniscience and ordinary language without abandoning its critique of dogmatic partiality.

2.9 Is Jainism pluralistic and realistic? (2025) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: Yes, Jainism is strongly **pluralistic** and broadly **realistic**, though both labels require nuance.

Why pluralistic. FACT:

1. It accepts many real souls.

2. It accepts multiple irreducible substance (dravyas).
3. It rejects monistic reduction.
4. Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

Why realistic. FACT:

1. It treats substance (dravyas), qualities, and modes as objectively real.
2. The external world is not illusion.
3. Knowledge aims at real objects, though only under standpoints.

Nuance. ANALYSIS: Its realism is **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. But qualification of knowledge does not imply unreality of the object.

Objection (realist objection). FACT: If all knowledge is relative to standpoint, realism weakens.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism separates ontological realism from epistemic non-absolutism: reality is objective, but our finite access to it is partial.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2021, Q7(c), 15 marks: define the doctrinal chain, list all seven predicates in order, apply one jar example, block the contradiction objection, and conclude that this is disciplined conditional predication.

2022, Q6(b), 15 marks: reconstruct the absolutism objection fairly, distinguish non-absolutism from sceptical relativism, use *perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)* as the Jaina reply, and concede the residual burden.

2023, Q5(a), 10 marks: qualify the quotation "all human knowledge is empirical and relative" using the fivefold knowledge scheme.

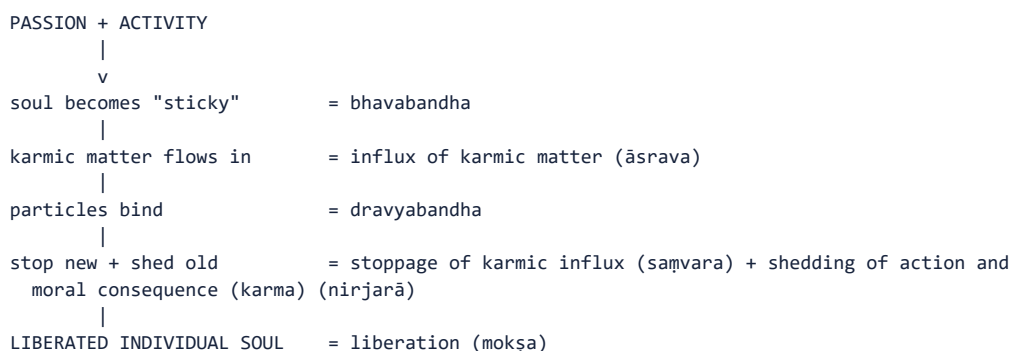
LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Seven *nayas* are standpoint disciplines; seven *bhaṅgas* are predicative forms.
- *Syāt* means "in some respect", not "perhaps" or mere probability.
- Third form asserts is-and-is-not successively or under different qualifications.
- *Avaktavya* marks the limit of one simple utterance, not total unknowability.
- Trap: the blind-men-and-elephant story illustrates partiality, not equality of all opinions.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the dust and wet-cloth model



In simple words: anger, pride, deceit and greed create the inner condition for bondage. Subtle karmic matter then attaches to the soul and obscures its natural knowledge. Liberation removes the obstruction; it does not create a new soul.

Core term	Easy meaning
<i>Influx of karmic matter (āsrava)</i>	Influx of karmic matter
<i>Bondage (bandha)</i>	Binding

Core term	Easy meaning
Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)	Stopping new influx
Shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)	Shedding old action and moral consequence (karma)
Liberation (mokṣa)	Complete freedom with individuality retained

Memory line: inner passion causes material bondage; restraint stops it and discipline removes it.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - STANDPOINT ANALYSIS (nayavāda), QUALIFIED ASSERTION (syādvāda) AND SEVENFOLD PREDICATION (saptabhaṅgī)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | STANDPOINT ANALYSIS (nayavāda), QUALIFIED ASSERTION (syādvāda) AND SEVENFOLD

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

standpoint analysis (nayavāda) · qualified assertion (syādvāda) ·

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. FACT: Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) teaches that every ordinary

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse nayas (standpoints) with the sevenfold

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) systematises conditional

SESSION 5 - KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Liberation occurs when karmic influx is stopped and accumulated karmic matter is completely shed, allowing the soul's intrinsic knowledge and energy to manifest unobstructed.

Technical definition: Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravyabandha.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jain liberation is not divine pardon but causal purification: stoppage (saṃvara) prevents new karmic influx, while shedding (nirjarā) removes the matter already binding the soul.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- karmic matter (pudgala)
- influx (āsrava)
- bondage (bandha)
- stoppage (saṃvara)
- shedding (nirjarā)
- three jewels (ratnatraya)

How to use them: Present bondage as the material adhesion of action and moral consequence (karma) to the soul, then show how right vision, knowledge and conduct stop new influx and shed accumulated action and moral consequence (karma).

EXAM-READY LINE: Jaina bondage begins when influx of karmic matter (āsrava) (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bondage (bandha) binds it; stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) (stoppage) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) (shedding) culminate in liberation (mokṣa).

3.1 Action and moral consequence (karma) as subtle material substance

Statement. FACT: Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that **action and moral consequence (karma) is a subtle material substance**, a form of **pudgala** that flows toward and binds the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul's intrinsic omniscience is obscured in empirical life.
2. This obscuration requires a real binding factor.
3. That factor is action and moral consequence (karma), conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.
4. Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical and cognitive defilement must have a concrete causal structure.

Distinction. FACT: This is a crucial UPSC trap: in Jainism action and moral consequence (karma) is **material**, unlike many Hindu presentations where action and moral consequence (karma) is a moral force, merit-demerit ledger, or adṛṣṭa.

Example. FACT: Passions attract karmic particles just as a sticky surface gathers dust.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can matter bind a conscious immaterial soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism answers through intimate association and obscuration, though critics often say the mechanism remains conceptually difficult.

3.2 The fivefold soteriological sequence FACT:

Statement. FACT: The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence **influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa).**

Stage	Meaning
Influx of karmic matter (āsrava)	influx of karmic matter into the soul
Bondage (bandha)	bondage; karmic matter adheres to the soul
Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)	stoppage of fresh inflow
Shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)	shedding or exhaustion of accumulated action and moral consequence (karma)
Liberation (mokṣa)	complete release from action and moral consequence (karma)

Argument. FACT:

1. Wrong belief, passions, and activity open the soul to karmic influx.
2. Influx produces bondage.
3. Discipline blocks new inflow.
4. Austerity and purification burn off old action and moral consequence (karma).
5. When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress is both preventive and purgative.

Distinction. FACT: Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) are not the same: one stops new action and moral consequence (karma); the other removes old action and moral consequence (karma).

Example. FACT: Closing a muddy stream into a tank is like stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara); cleaning the sediment already deposited is like shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā).

Objection (Buddhist/Vedānta-style objection). FACT: The process may seem mechanically moralistic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Its strength is exactly its causal clarity: vice has ontological consequence; discipline has ontological remedy.

3.3 Bhāvabandha and dravyabandha (2024) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Bondage has two closely related forms: **bhāvabandha** (psychic bondage) and **dravyabandha** (material bondage).

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.
2. This inner deformation is **bhāvabandha**.
3. Corresponding karmic particles then attach materially to the soul.
4. This actual material adhesion is **dravyabandha**.
5. Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Inner states are causally efficacious; moral psychology precedes material karmic accretion.

Distinction. FACT:

- **Bhāvabandha** = subjective, intentional, affective bondage.
- **Dravyabandha** = objective, material bondage by karmic pudgala.

Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravyabandha.

Objection (analytical objection). FACT: Why not collapse them into one process?

Reply. FACT: The distinction helps Jainism explain both moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul's state, the other is the karmic material result.

3.4 The three jewels FACT:

Statement. FACT: Liberation requires the **three jewels (ratnatraya): samyag-darśana** (right faith/vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyag-cāritra** (right conduct).

Argument. FACT:

1. One must first see reality correctly.
2. One must know it correctly.
3. One must live in accordance with that insight.
4. Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.
5. Mere conduct without right view lacks orientation.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

Distinction. FACT: The three jewels are not sequential in a crude external sense; they are mutually reinforcing dimensions of one path.

Example. FACT: One who knows non-violence conceptually but continues harmful conduct has not completed the path.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Is "faith" here blind belief?

Reply. FACT: No. Samyag-darśana is right apprehension or trustful orientation to truth, not irrational fideism.

3.5 Five mahāvratas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Right conduct is classically articulated through the **five mahāvratas: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, and aparigraha**.

Argument. FACT: These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.

Vow	Basic meaning	Soteriological relevance
Ahimsā	non-violence	central because injury binds action and moral consequence (karma) deeply
Satya	truthfulness	purifies speech and intention
Asteya	non-stealing	curbs acquisitive harm
Brahmacharya	chastity / control of sensuality	disciplines desire
Aparigraha	non-possession / non-attachment	reduces grasping and karmic adhesion

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.

Distinction. FACT: In Jainism ahiṃsā is not only a moral ideal but a central soteriological technology.

Example. FACT: Extreme care toward even one-sense beings follows from the pluralistic doctrine of conscious soul (jīva).

Objection (householder-pragmatic objection). FACT: Such rigor seems too severe for ordinary life.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes full vows for ascetics and limited observances for householders, preserving the ideal while allowing graded practice.

3.6 Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul is intrinsically omniscient.
2. Ignorance is due to karmic obstruction.
3. Remove the obstruction and the native luminosity manifests completely.
4. Therefore perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is revelation of what the soul truly is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

Distinction. FACT: Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) differs from scriptural knowledge and extraordinary clairvoyance; it is total, direct, unobstructed knowledge.

Example. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkara is revered as one who attained such perfect knowledge.

Objection (Buddhist/Cārvāka objection). FACT: Omniscience seems excessive or unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jaina metaphysics, omniscience is the natural terminus of complete karmic purification.

3.7 Liberation (mokṣa) FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Liberation (mokṣa)** is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to **siddha-śīlā**.

Argument. FACT:

1. Bondage is due to karmic accretion.
2. Complete stoppage and exhaustion of action and moral consequence (karma) eliminate bondage.
3. The soul then manifests its intrinsic excellences unobstructed.
4. Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is individual and cosmologically locatable within the Jaina universe.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita liberation (mokṣa), this is not merger into impersonal Brahman. Unlike Buddhist cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa), it is liberation of a distinct enduring conscious soul (jīva).

Example. FACT: The liberated soul is a **siddha**, no longer embodied, no longer karmically entangled.

Objection (modern philosophical objection). FACT: Spatial ascent of a liberated soul may seem mythic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: In doctrinal exposition, one should report the cosmological picture faithfully while separating canonical doctrine from modern philosophical evaluation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS karmic matter (pudgala) · influx (āsrava) · bondage (bandha) · stoppage	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāva-bandha; the karmic matter	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Unlike Buddhist cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa), it is	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: thus psychic and material bondage
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jain liberation is not divine pardon but causal purification:			

SESSION 6 - SEVEN PRINCIPLES (tattvas), NINE CATEGORIES (padārthas) AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The nine categories (padārthas) are the same seven principles (tattvas) plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).

Technical definition: Statement. FACT: The seven principles (tattvas) (real categories for liberation-analysis) are conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha), stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara), shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā), and liberation (mokṣa).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The nine categories extend the seven liberation principles by separately counting merit and demerit, while the karma-prakṛtis specify what capacities or embodiments bondage obstructs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- seven principles (tattvas)
- nine categories (padārthas)
- merit (puṇya)
- demerit (pāpa)
- destructive karmas (ghātiyā)
- non-destructive karmas (aghātiyā)

How to use them: Use the seven principles (tattvas) as the liberation process, explain the nine categories (padārthas) as that scheme plus merit and demerit, and classify karmas by what they obscure.

3A.1 Seven principles (tattvas) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The seven **principles (tattvas)** (real categories for liberation-analysis) are **conscious soul (jīva)**, **non-conscious reality (ajīva)**, **influx of karmic matter (āsrava)**, **bondage (bandha)**, **stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)**, **shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)**, and **liberation (mokṣa)**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Conscious soul (jīva)** and **non-conscious reality (ajīva)** identify the two broad ontological poles.
2. FACT: **Influx of karmic matter (āsrava)** explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.
3. FACT: **Bondage (bandha)** explains how that matter becomes bound.
4. FACT: **Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)** explains the stopping of new influx.
5. FACT: **Shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)** explains the shedding or wearing away of accumulated action and moral consequence (karma).
6. FACT: **Liberation (mokṣa)** names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

Distinction. FACT: The tattva-list moves from what exists to what binds and what liberates.

Example. FACT: A person's anger is not merely a mental event; it opens influx of karmic matter (āsrava), deepens bondage (bandha), and must be countered by stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā).

Objection (Buddhist-style objection). FACT: The list seems to reify a permanent soul and material action and moral consequence (karma) beyond observable process.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that without conscious soul (jīva) and karma-pudgala, bondage and liberation cannot be explained as real transformation of an enduring knower.

3A.2 Nine categories (padārthas) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The nine **categories (padārthas)** are the same seven principles (tattvas) plus **puṇya** (merit) and **pāpa** (demerit).

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Seven principles (tattvas)	FACT: conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha), stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara), shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā), liberation (mokṣa)	FACT: Standard liberation-sequence framework
Nine categories (padārthas)	FACT: the seven plus puṇya and pāpa	FACT: Makes moral valence explicit

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.
2. ANALYSIS: They can also be subsumed under influx of karmic matter (āsrava) and bondage (bandha) because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.
3. ANALYSIS: Hence some expositions emphasize seven for soteriological mechanics and nine for moral classification.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Even “good” action and moral consequence (karma) remains karmic bondage if it keeps the soul within cycle of rebirth (saṃsāra).

Distinction. FACT: Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for liberation (mokṣa).

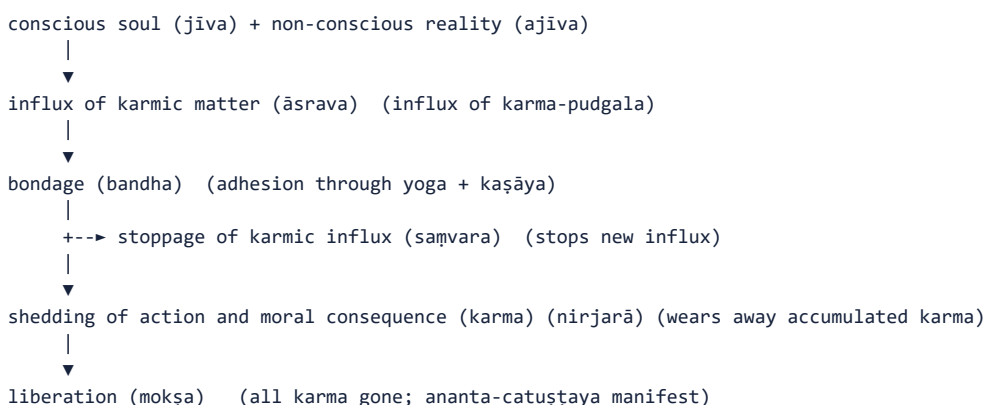
Example. FACT: Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: If puṇya is morally valuable, why treat it as ultimately part of bondage?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ethical improvement within cycle of rebirth (saṃsāra) from final release beyond all karmic determination.

3A.3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul’s **ananta-catuṣṭaya** (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.



Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The soul does not manufacture omniscience from nothing.
2. FACT: It removes what obscures its intrinsic cognitive and blissful capacity.
3. FACT: Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is therefore revealed rather than produced.
4. FACT: Liberation (mokṣa) is the purified manifestation of what the conscious soul (jīva) essentially is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The self is intrinsically capable of perfection, but empirically veiled by beginningless action and moral consequence (karma).

Distinction. FACT: Jaina liberation (mokṣa) is not acquisition of God's grace, not merger into Brahman, and not annihilation of self; it is release of an individual conscious soul (jīva) from karmic matter.

Example. FACT: Cleaning a sooted lamp does not create light; it allows light to shine unobstructed.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is intrinsically omniscient, why was it obscured at all?

Reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but purification can terminate the bondage.

3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS AND THE MECHANICS OF BONDAGE (bandha) FACT:

3B.1 Action and moral consequence (karma) is material pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that action and moral consequence (karma) is literally material: **karma-pudgala** is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Empirical ignorance, delusion, embodied limitation, status, pleasure-pain, and lifespan require causal explanation.
2. FACT: Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.
3. FACT: **Bhāva-karma** (the soul's psychical state) attracts **dravya-karma** (material karmic influx).
4. FACT: Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Moral causation is not merely legal or symbolic; it is a real interaction between a modified soul and subtle matter.

Distinction. FACT: This differs sharply from Nyāya **adrṣṭa**, Mīmāṃsā **apūrva**, Sāṃkhya **saṃskāra**, and Buddhist **vāsanā**, which are not material karmic particles.

Example. FACT: Anger makes the soul "sticky," as oil or wet clay gathers dust; the image expresses the causal role of kaṣāya.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can material action and moral consequence (karma) bind an immaterial conscious soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the embodied conscious soul (jīva) is not absolutely non-spatial: it has **pradeśas**, is co-extensive with the body, and is modified by bhāva-karma; karmic matter is attracted through passions. ANALYSIS: A residual difficulty remains because interaction between consciousness and matter still demands explanation.

3B.2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis FACT:

Class	Karma-prakṛti	What it obscures or determines	Philosophical significance
Ghātiyā	FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya	knowledge	FACT: Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Ghātiyā	FACT: Darśanāvaraṇīya	perception or apprehension	FACT: Blocks direct awareness
Ghātiyā	FACT: Mohanīya	right vision and conduct	FACT: Most dangerous because delusion misorients the path
Ghātiyā	FACT: Antarāya	energy, power, capacity to act	FACT: Obstructs the soul's effective power
Aghātiyā	FACT: Vedanīya	pleasure and pain	FACT: Determines felt experience without destroying essence
Aghātiyā	FACT: Nāma	body, form, embodiment	FACT: Determines the type of body and individuality of embodiment
Aghātiyā	FACT: Gotra	status or family-standing	FACT: Determines high or low status conditions
Aghātiyā	FACT: Āyus	lifespan	FACT: Determines duration of embodied life

Statement. FACT: The eight karmas divide into **ghātiyā** karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and **aghātiyā** karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātiyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.
2. FACT: Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātiyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.
3. FACT: **Mohanīya** is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.
4. FACT: Mohanīya is commonly divided into **darśana-mohanīya** and **cāritra-mohanīya**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul's essential nature.

Distinction. FACT: The arhat at the **sayoga-kevalī** stage has destroyed ghātiyā karmas but still lives with remaining aghātiyā karmas until final release.

Example. FACT: A kevalin has omniscience because knowledge-obscuring action and moral consequence (karma) is destroyed, but embodied life continues until lifespan-determining action and moral consequence (karma) is exhausted.

Objection (Buddhist objection). FACT: The taxonomy seems metaphysically heavy compared with a mental-volitional account of action and moral consequence (karma).

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts the heaviness because it wants a realist explanation of why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure, and lifespan are all karmically structured.

3B.3 Four parameters of bondage (bandha) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: **primordial material nature (prakṛti)** (type or nature), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga** or **rasa** (intensity), and **pradeśa** (quantity of karmic matter).

Bandha-parameter	Meaning	Main determinant
Primordial material nature (prakṛti)	FACT: type of action and moral consequence (karma) bound	FACT: Yoga (activity of body, speech, and mind)
Sthiti	FACT: duration of bondage	FACT: Kaṣāya (passions)
Anubhāga / rasa	FACT: intensity or fruition-strength	FACT: Kaṣāya
Pradeśa	FACT: quantity of karmic matter bound	FACT: Yoga

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Yoga** brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and determines type and quantity.
2. FACT: **Kaṣāya** makes the bondage deep, long-lasting, and intense.
3. FACT: Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.
4. FACT: This explains the contrast between **īryāpathika bondage (bandha)** (momentary bondage from activity without passion) and **sāmparāyika bondage (bandha)** (durable bondage from passion-coloured activity).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is not crude physicalism: material action and moral consequence (karma) binds through psychical states; passion is doctrinally decisive.

Example. FACT: A monk's careful walking may involve bodily activity, but if free from passion it binds only momentarily; an angry act binds deeply because kaṣāya fixes the action and moral consequence (karma).

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-Nyāya objection). FACT: This mechanism seems more elaborate than needed to explain moral consequence.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the elaboration is the point: it explains why intention, passion, duration, intensity, and embodiment are linked in a single karmic science.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SEVEN PRINCIPLES (tattvas), NINE CATEGORIES (padārthas) AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SEVEN PRINCIPLES (tattvas), NINE CATEGORIES (padārthas) AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

seven principles (tattvas) · nine categories (padārthas) · merit

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. FACT: The seven principles (tattvas) (real categories for

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. FACT: Jaina liberation (mokṣa) is not acquisition of God's

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

They can also be subsumed under influx of karmic matter (āsrava) and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The nine categories extend the seven liberation principles by

SESSION 7 - GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

Technical definition: Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The fourteen stages (guṇasthānas) map liberation as the progressive removal of delusion, passion and activity until omniscience and disembodied perfection become possible.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- fourteen stages (guṇasthānas)
- right vision
- passion (kaṣāya)
- omniscience (kevala-jñāna)
- activity (yoga)
- fast unto death (sallekhanā)

How to use them: Trace the guṇasthānas as decreasing delusion, passion and activity, and discuss sallekhana only as disciplined non-attachment under strict ethical conditions.

3C.1 Ordered list FACT:

Statement. FACT: The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
1	FACT: Mithyā-dṛṣṭi	false vision; complete wrong orientation
2	FACT: Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna	falling condition with a lingering taste of right vision
3	FACT: Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi	mixed right and wrong orientation
4	FACT: Avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	right vision without full restraint
5	FACT: Deśavirata	partial restraint, especially lay vows
6	FACT: Pramatta-samyata	full restraint with negligence
7	FACT: Apramatta-samyata	full restraint without negligence
8	FACT: Apūrva-karaṇa / nivṛtti-bādhara	unprecedented purification; gross passions being transformed
9	FACT: Anivṛtti-bādhara	further advanced purification of gross passions

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
10	FACT: Sūkṣma-samparāya	only subtle greed remains
11	FACT: Upaśānta-moha	delusion suppressed, not destroyed
12	FACT: Kṣīṇa-moha	delusion destroyed
13	FACT: Sayoga-kevalī	omniscient embodied arhat with activity still present
14	FACT: Ayoga-kevalī	activity ceases; momentary final state before siddhatva

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The first three stages describe wrong, falling, or mixed vision.
2. FACT: Stage 4 is decisive because **samyag-darśana** first becomes stable enough to orient the path.
3. FACT: Stages 5-7 discipline conduct through partial and full restraint.
4. FACT: Stages 8-10 refine passions from gross to extremely subtle.
5. FACT: Stages 11-12 mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion.
6. FACT: Stages 13-14 explain how omniscience and final disembodiment are related.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is gradual, psychologically exact, and karmically measurable.

Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

Example. FACT: A layperson with right vision and partial vows belongs doctrinally closer to stage 5 than to complete monastic purification.

Objection (Advaita-style objection). FACT: A fourteen-stage ladder may seem to turn liberation into a mechanical sequence rather than insight.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that insight, conduct, and karmic purification must be integrated; right vision without progressive destruction of action and moral consequence (karma) is incomplete.

3C.2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina doctrine distinguishes **upaśama-śreṇi** (ladder of suppression) and **kṣapaka-śreṇi** (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Upaśama-śreṇi** suppresses delusion and can reach stage 11.
2. FACT: Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.
3. FACT: **Kṣapaka-śreṇi** destroys delusion and reaches stage 12 and beyond.
4. FACT: At stage 13 the **sayoga-kevalī** has perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) but still retains embodied activity because aghātiyā karmas remain.
5. FACT: Stage 14, **ayoga-kevalī**, is the momentary cessation of activity immediately before **siddhatva**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Suppression is spiritually unstable; destruction alone is final.

Distinction. FACT: The sayoga-kevalī is the Jaina answer to “is jīvanmukti possible?”: the embodied omniscient arhat is liberated-in-life in the Jaina sense, though final siddha-state follows only after remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted.

Example. FACT: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even before the lamp is relocated; similarly the arhat is omniscient while embodied.

Objection (Rāmānuja-style objection). FACT: Omniscience while embodied may seem unintelligible if embodiment itself implies limitation.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ghātiyā karmas, which obstruct essential knowledge, from aghātiyā karmas, which sustain embodiment without blocking omniscience.

3D. SALLEKHANĀ / SANTHĀRĀ: DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Bondage tracks **kaṣāya**: passion fixes karmic matter more deeply than bare activity.
2. FACT: A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.
3. FACT: The aim is not to end life as such but to end passion at the moment when life is already naturally or medically approaching its close.
4. FACT: The practice must be free from desire for death, desire to continue living, attachment to friends, recollection of pleasures, and hope of reward.
5. FACT: If such motives enter, the act becomes an **aticāra** (transgression) of the vow's proper discipline.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The karmic quality of dying depends on the inner state with which death is faced.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from **ātma-ghāta** (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

Example. FACT: An elderly ascetic or lay practitioner facing irreversible decline may gradually reduce intake under religious supervision while cultivating forgiveness, detachment, and equanimity.

Objection (modern legal-ethical objection). CAUTION: Critics in India have disputed whether sallekhanā is protected religious practice or an impermissible form of self-destruction.

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that legal and ethical evaluation must distinguish intention, procedure, publicity, non-violence, and the absence of death-desire; the controversy is a useful Paper II bridge to religion and morality, but specific case names, holdings, dates, and statutory details should not be asserted unless separately verified.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2018, Q6(c), 15 marks: define bondage, distinguish bound and liberated souls, explain *bhāvabandha/dravyabandha*, and state the liberated condition.

2020, Q5(a), 10 marks and 2022, Q5(d), 10 marks: focus on the bearing of material action and moral consequence (karma) on liberation through *āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā-mokṣa*.

2024, Q6(c), 15 marks: make the psychic/material distinction causal, not merely definitional, and add the four parameters of material bondage.

Use the three jewels and vows as mechanisms of *stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)* and *shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)*, not as an ornamental ethical list.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Action and moral consequence (karma) is subtle material *pudgala*, not merely moral memory.
- Four *kaṣāyas*: anger, pride, deceit and greed.
- Seven *principles (tattvas)*; nine *categories (padārthas)* add merit and demerit.
- Eight karma-types divide into four destructive and four non-destructive classes.
- Four bondage (bandha) parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.
- Liberation reveals intrinsic knowledge and bliss; individual *siddhas* do not merge.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - what each rival attacks

BUDDHISM -> Why posit a permanent soul?
 ADVAITA -> How can opposites be finally real?
 NYAYA -> How does soul expand with the body?
 CARVAKA -> Where is evidence for action and moral consequence (karma) and omniscience?
 JAINA REPLY -> each criticism absolutises one dimension

In simple words: rival schools attack different joints of the Jaina system. A good answer must name the target accurately before giving the Jaina reply.

Rival	Main pressure point
Buddhism	Permanence amid change
Advaita	Real plurality and opposed predicates
Nyāya	Soul-body extension and material action and moral consequence (karma)
Cārvāka	Unverifiable soul, action and moral consequence (karma) and omniscience

Memory line: state the critic's criterion first; then show what the Jaina distinction saves and what burden remains.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

fourteen stages (guṇasthānas) · right vision · passion (kaṣāya) ·

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide):

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Keep the doctrine's claim, supporting argument and residual limitation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The fourteen stages (guṇasthānas) map liberation as the progressive

SESSION 8 - JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Inter-school comparison identifies how Jain realism and qualified predication differ from Buddhist process theory, Advaita non-dualism and Cārvāka materialism.

Technical definition: Jainism combines enduring substances with changing modes, thereby opposing Buddhist momentariness, Advaita's ultimate non-duality and Cārvāka's rejection of supersensible bondage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism occupies a distinctive middle position: it is realist without absolutist finite predication and pluralist without denying the disciplined possibility of truth.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Jain plural realism
- Buddhist momentariness
- Advaita non-dualism
- Cārvāka materialism
- soul (jīva)
- conditional predication

How to use them: Compare the schools on substance, self, change, action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation, using Jaina many-sidedness to explain both its realism and its resistance to one-sided alternatives.

EXAM-READY LINE: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

4.1 Jainism vs Buddhism on reality

Axis	Jainism	Buddhism
Self	Many enduring conscious soul (jīvas)	Anātman / no enduring self-substance
Reality	Substance with permanence-in-change	Strong tendency to momentariness in many schools
Logic of judgement	Conditional many-sided predication	Often sharper critiques of substantial identity
Action and moral consequence (karma)	Material karmic accretion	Moral-causal continuity without material karmic particles
Liberation	Distinct soul freed from action and moral consequence (karma)	Cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) without eternal self

4.2 Jainism vs Advaita Vedānta

Axis	Jainism	Advaita
Ultimate reality	Pluralistic	Non-dual Brahman
World	Real	Empirically real, ultimately dependent / mithyā
Souls	Many real conscious soul (jīvas)	Ultimately one enduring self (ātman)/Brahman
Ignorance/bondage	Karmic material obscuration	Ignorance (avidyā) / adhyāsa
Liberation	Distinct siddhas	Realization of non-duality

4.3 Jainism vs Cārvāka

Axis	Jainism	Cārvāka
Ontology	Pluralist realism with soul and action and moral consequence (karma)	Materialist minimalism
Action and moral consequence (karma)	Material and real	Rejected
Liberation	Central	Denied or emptied
Logic	Conditional predication	Suspicion of inference and testimony
Ethics	Austerity and ahiṃsā	This-worldly pleasure and prudence

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Jain plural realism · Buddhist momentariness · Advaita non-dualism ·

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The comparison turns on whether reality contains enduring substances,

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Jainism preserves plurality and persistence while explaining change

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not equate Jain non-absolutism with Buddhist emptiness or Advaita's

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism occupies a distinctive middle position: it is realist

SESSION 9 - NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jain replies answer contradiction and relativism charges by showing that qualified predicates concern different aspects or conditions of a many-sided object.

Technical definition: Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua substance (dravya) and changing qua mode (paryāya).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jaina qualification avoids contradiction by indexing opposed predicates to distinct respects, places, times and modes, though critics still question whether endless qualification can sustain final assertion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- contradiction objection
- relativism objection
- same respect
- place (kṣetra)
- time (kāla)
- mode (bhāva)

How to use them: State the critic's charge precisely, then reply that opposed predicates become contradictory only when asserted of the same object in the same respect, place, time and mode.

EXAM-READY LINE: The charge that many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

5.1 Śaṅkara's critique of many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Śaṅkara, in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya*, criticizes Jaina many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.
2. FACT: If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no," practical action loses clear guidance.
3. FACT: If many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) asserts itself absolutely, it contradicts itself.
4. FACT: If it asserts itself only conditionally, it seems to lose universal force.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A viable metaphysics must preserve non-contradiction and assertoric clarity.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: substance (dravya), **kṣetra** (place), **kāla** (time), and **bhāva** (mode).
2. FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode.
3. FACT: Qualified assertion (syādvāda) is itself asserted **syāt**; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule.
4. ANALYSIS: A residual objection remains: if qualified assertion (syādvāda) is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

5.2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes FACT:

Statement. FACT: Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.
2. FACT: If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.
3. FACT: If they are not real, Jaina realism weakens.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Real predication must avoid contradiction at the level of the object, not merely at the level of language.

Jaina reply. FACT: The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same substance (dravya) persists while paryāyas arise and cease, so the opposition is between aspects, not within one unqualified predication.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply works best if one accepts the substance (dravya)-mode (paryāya) distinction; it is less persuasive to schools that reject such aspect-realism.

5.3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.
2. FACT: What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.
3. FACT: A permanent entity that changes faces the **arthakriyā** (causal efficacy) dilemma: if it acts, it changes; if it does not change, it cannot act.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Causal efficacy and permanence are difficult to combine in one substance.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism replies through **utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya**: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua substance (dravya) and changing qua mode (paryāya).

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The Buddhist objection remains strong if one denies the real distinction between substance and modes.

5.4 Nyāya critique of the soul's expansion and material action and moral consequence (karma) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.
2. FACT: If the self has parts or pradeśas, its eternality seems threatened.
3. FACT: Material action and moral consequence (karma) is less parsimonious than an unseen moral potency such as adṛṣṭa.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A permanent self should be partless or at least not spatially variable.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism invokes **pradeśas** and the lamp simile: consciousness can pervade the body without being identical with gross matter, and karmic pudgala explains concrete embodiment better than a merely invisible potency.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of conscious pradeśa-bearing conscious soul (jīva) and matter remains a debated point.

5.5 Sāṃkhya/Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.
2. FACT: If action and moral consequence (karma) began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.
3. FACT: If action and moral consequence (karma) never began, liberation may seem impossible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A theory of bondage must explain both its origin and its removal.

Jaina reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but disciplined stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) can terminate the relation.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply blocks a first-cause demand but leaves a metaphysical puzzle about why beginningless bondage is possible for an intrinsically perfect soul.

5.6 Cārvāka / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.

Argument of the critic. FACT: Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

Jaina reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism combines testimony, inference, moral phenomenology, and the internal logic of purification to defend these doctrines, but it cannot satisfy a strict materialist who admits only gross perception.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: Use this objection only as an external critique; do not let it replace the named classical objections above.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

Use a four-column dialectic: **critic -> exact objection -> Jaina distinction/reply -> residual problem.**

For "critically discuss", exposition must come before criticism. For comparison, select named axes rather than writing two isolated summaries. The **2025 pluralism and realism** PYQ is the best place to integrate Buddhist, Advaita, Nyāya and Cārvāka pressure.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Criticism is strongest when its criterion is named.
- Indexed opposites answer contradiction better than the slogan "all views are true".
- Permanent substance explains continuity but increases ontological commitment.
- Material action and moral consequence (karma) integrates ethics and embodiment but creates an interaction problem.
- Omniscience blocks total relativism but needs independent support.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

```

DEFINE THE AXIS
|
RECONSTRUCT JAINA DOCTRINE
|
SHOW THE INTERNAL LINK
reality -> judgement -> conduct -> liberation
|
ADD NAMED OBJECTION + BEST REPLY
|
GIVE A QUALIFIED VERDICT

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In simple words: a Jaina answer scores when it shows relationships. Do not merely list six substances, seven predicates or five stages; explain why each structure follows from the larger system.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> core mechanism -> distinction -> verdict
15	Doctrine -> structure/example -> criticism/reply -> assessment
20	Full derivation -> comparison -> dialectic -> criterion-based conclusion

Memory line: many-sided reality requires qualified judgement; purified judgement and conduct remove bondage.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

EXAM TRAPS, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE AND GRADED VERDICT

1. **Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) ≠ qualified assertion (syādvāda) ≠ sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī).** FACT: Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.
2. **Action and moral consequence (karma) in Jainism is material (pudgala).** FACT: Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.
3. **Six substance (dravyas), but only five astikāyas.** FACT: Kāla is a substance (dravya) but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the substance (dravya) list has six.
4. **Jainism rejects God as creator but not spiritual excellence.** FACT: Liberated souls and Tīrthaṅkaras are worthy of reverence, but there is no creator-God.
5. **Bhāvabandha ≠ dravyabandha.** FACT: Psychic bondage is not identical with material karmic bondage, though they are linked.
6. **Dharma / adharma in ontology do not mean moral merit / sin.** FACT: They are media of motion and rest.
7. **Seven nayas are not the same as seven bhāṅgas.** FACT: One is standpoint taxonomy; the other is predication schema.
8. **Jainism is realist despite epistemic relativity.** ANALYSIS: Partial knowledge does not imply unreal objects.
9. **Jaina perception (pratyakṣa) is inverted.** FACT: Strict perception (pratyakṣa) is soul-direct knowledge; ordinary sense-perception is only sāmvyavahārika perception (pratyakṣa).
10. **Puṇya is not liberation (mokṣa).** FACT: Merit may improve saṃsāric condition but still belongs to karmic involvement.
11. **Ghātiyā ≠ aghātiyā action and moral consequence (karma).** FACT: Ghātiyā karmas obstruct essential qualities; aghātiyā karmas determine embodiment.
12. **Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta.** FACT: Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātiyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.

7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT:

- **Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)** - doctrine of many-sided reality. FACT:
- **Sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya** - reality involves origination, decay, and permanence. FACT:
- **Substance (dravya)-quality (guṇa)-mode (paryāya)** - substance, qualities, modes. FACT:
- **Conscious soul (jīva) / non-conscious reality (ajīva)** - conscious and non-conscious reals. FACT:
- **Qualified assertion (syādvāda)** - conditional predication. FACT:
- **Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)** - sevenfold judgement-schema. FACT:
- **Bhāvabandha / dravyabandha** - psychic and material bondage. FACT:
- **Ratnatraya** - right faith, right knowledge, right conduct. FACT:
- **Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** - omniscience of the purified soul. FACT:
- **Siddha-śilā** - topmost locus of liberated souls. FACT:
- **Exam sentence:** "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." ANALYSIS:
- **Exam sentence:** "The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating action and moral consequence (karma) not merely as moral record but as subtle material bondage requiring both stoppage and shedding." ANALYSIS:

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Bound and liberated soul

- FACT: **Bondage:** karmic matter flows toward the conscious soul (jīva) through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

- **FACT: Liberation sequence:** stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) stops new influx; shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) sheds accumulated action and moral consequence (karma); the purified conscious soul (jīva) rises to the siddha-śīlā and remains an individual perfected soul.
- **ANALYSIS: Distinction:** the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.
- **CAUTION: Objection -> reply:** material action and moral consequence (karma) interacting with an immaterial conscious soul (jīva) appears category-confused. Jainism treats karmic matter as subtle and invokes the conscious soul (jīva)'s embodied expansion/contraction, though the mechanism remains contestable.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018-2025 audit)

- **ANALYSIS: Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.
- **FACT: Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and action and moral consequence (karma)'s direct bearing on liberation.
- **WRONG: Trap / answer consequence:** Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual conscious soul (jīva).

7A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)	ANALYSIS: Reality has many real aspects, not merely many subjective descriptions	ANALYSIS: Jaina non-absolutism becomes either skepticism or loose tolerance
Standpoint analysis (nayavāda)	ANALYSIS: Finite cognition grasps objects through partial standpoints	ANALYSIS: Partial truths become either falsehoods or dogmatic absolutes
Qualified assertion (syādvāda) / sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)	ANALYSIS: Language must register standpoint, time, place, substance, and mode	ANALYSIS: Conditional predication looks like contradiction or indecision
Substance (dravya) as utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya	ANALYSIS: Permanence and change are both objectively real in different respects	ANALYSIS: Jainism collapses either into Buddhist flux or static monism
Five/six substances and astikāya	ANALYSIS: Substance and spatial extension must be distinguished	ANALYSIS: Kāla is confused with the five astikāyas, and pluralist cosmology loses precision
Material action and moral consequence (karma)	ANALYSIS: Moral-psychical states can attract subtle matter	ANALYSIS: Bondage becomes metaphorical and Jaina soteriology loses its distinctive mechanism
Guṇasthāna progression	ANALYSIS: Spiritual development is gradual and karmically measurable	ANALYSIS: Liberation becomes abrupt insight without Jaina moral psychology
Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)	ANALYSIS: The soul's infinite knowledge is intrinsic but obscured	ANALYSIS: Liberation (mokṣa) becomes acquisition rather than revelation through removal
Ahiṃsā	ANALYSIS: All living conscious soul (jīvas) are morally significant and injury binds action and moral consequence (karma)	ANALYSIS: Jaina ethics loses its metaphysical foundation

7B. OPPONENT'S PRIMA-FACIE POSITION (pūrvapakṣa)-ESTABLISHED CONCLUSION (siddhānta) LEDGER FACT:

Objector (named)	Objection	Jaina reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
Śaṃkara	FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) allows contradiction and cannot assert itself consistently	FACT: Predicates are indexed to substance (dravya), kṣetra, kāla, and bhāva; qualified assertion (syādvāda) is itself asserted syāt	ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified doctrine may seem to lose assertoric force
Rāmānuja	FACT: A real substance with opposed real attributes is unintelligible	FACT: Opposed predicates belong to different aspects of substance (dravya) and mode (paryāya)	ANALYSIS: Reply depends on accepting aspect-realism
Dharmakīrti / Buddhist	FACT: Permanent yet changing soul fails the arthakriyā test	FACT: Utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya: permanence as substance (dravya), change as mode (paryāya)	ANALYSIS: Strong if substance-mode distinction is denied
Nyāya	FACT: Soul's expansion/contraction and material action and moral consequence (karma) are unparsimonious	FACT: Conscious soul (jīva) has pradeśas and pervades the body like a lamp; karma-pudgala explains embodiment	ANALYSIS: Consciousness-matter interaction remains difficult
Sāṃkhya/Vedānta	FACT: Intrinsic omniscience plus beginningless obscuration seems puzzling	FACT: Jīva-karma relation is anādi but terminable through stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)	ANALYSIS: No first-origin explanation is offered
Cārvāka / empiricist	FACT: Soul, karma-pudgala, omniscience, and siddha-silā are not perceptually verified	ANALYSIS: Jainism uses inference, testimony, and systematic soteriology	ANALYSIS: Unpersuasive to strict perception-only materialism

7C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING FACT:

A. Knowledge, self and change

School	Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) admitted	Self	Permanence vs change
Jainism	FACT: Perception (pratyakṣa) and parokṣa; developed accounts include inference (anumāna), verbal testimony (śabda), smṛti, pratyabhijñā, hypothetical reasoning (tarka)	FACT: Many permanent conscious soul (jīvas)	FACT: Substance (dravya) permanent, mode (paryāya) changing
Buddhism	ANALYSIS: Usually perception and inference in classical epistemology	FACT: No permanent enduring self (ātman)	FACT: Momentariness in many schools
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: Many eternal selves	FACT: Substances endure; qualities change
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	FACT: Perception, inference, reliable testimony	FACT: Many conscious witness (puruṣas)	FACT: Conscious witness (puruṣa) changeless; primordial material nature (prakṛti) evolves
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Multiple means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) including verbal testimony (śabda); exact list varies by sub-school	FACT: Enduring self	FACT: World and Veda treated as real
Advaita	FACT: Six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) in standard Advaita pedagogy	FACT: Ultimately one ātman-Brahman	FACT: Brahman changeless; world mithyā
Cārvāka	FACT: Perception primarily	FACT: Body-based consciousness	FACT: Material change only

B. Universals, causation, God and liberation

School	Universals	Causation	Creator God	Liberation
Jainism	ANALYSIS: Real features grasped under standpoints	FACT: Sadasatkāryavāda : effect exists in one respect in the cause because substance (dravya) persists, and does not exist in another because mode (paryāya) is new	FACT: Anīśvaravāda : no creator; Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers	FACT: Individual siddha freed from all action and moral consequence (karma)
Buddhism	ANALYSIS: Often nominal or conceptual	ANALYSIS: Dependent origination, no permanent substrate	FACT: No creator God	FACT: Cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) without eternal soul-substance
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Universals real	FACT: Non-existence of the effect before production (asatkāryavāda); effect newly produced	FACT: Theistic in later Nyāya	FACT: Self freed from suffering, not Jaina omniscient bliss
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	ANALYSIS: Not central like Nyāya universals	FACT: Pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda); effect pre-exists in cause	FACT: Classical Sāṃkhya non-theistic; Yoga admits Lord (Īśvara) specially	FACT: Isolation (kaivalya) of conscious witness (puruṣa) from primordial material nature (prakṛti)
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Realist tendencies	ANALYSIS: Apūrva links ritual action and result	FACT: No creator required for Vedic authority	ANALYSIS: Often cessation of pain / ritual-moral fulfilment depending on account
Advaita	ANALYSIS: Ultimately sublated in non-duality	ANALYSIS: Vivarta-style appearance rather than real transformation	ANALYSIS: Lord (Īśvara) is empirical-soteriological, not ultimate second reality	FACT: Realization of non-duality
Cārvāka	CAUTION: Universals not central as real entities	ANALYSIS: Material causal regularity	FACT: Rejects creator God	FACT: Rejects liberation (mokṣa) or reduces goal to this-worldly life

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. FACT: Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. FACT: Jainism, however, affirms many permanent conscious soul (jīvas) and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are conscious soul (jīvas). FACT: Jaina action and moral consequence (karma) is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist action and moral consequence (karma) is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. ANALYSIS: Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

7D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON ANALYSIS:

Western comparison	Point of contact	Disanalogy
Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) and Nietzschean perspectivism	ANALYSIS: Both deny a simple “view from nowhere” for ordinary knowers	FACT: Jainism is realist: aspects are in the object; perspectivism is often read anti-realist
Qualified assertion (syādvāda) and many-valued / paraconsistent logic	ANALYSIS: Seven bhaṅgas resemble non-classical evaluation	FACT: Syāt is a standpoint-operator, not a third truth-value; avaktavya is inexpressibility in one unqualified utterance, not a truth-value gap
Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) and Hegelian dialectic	ANALYSIS: Both allow opposites within the real	FACT: Hegelian opposites are sublated into higher synthesis; Jaina aspects coexist without sublation
Ahiṃsā and Schweitzer’s reverence for life	ANALYSIS: Both widen moral concern toward life	FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is grounded in conscious soul (jīva), action and moral consequence (karma), and liberation, not only ethical reverence
Jaina souls and Leibnizian monads	ANALYSIS: Both are plural centres carrying their own history	FACT: Jaina souls interact with karmic matter and vary in spatial extension; monads do not interact materially in the same way
Material action and moral consequence (karma) and mechanistic psychology	ANALYSIS: Both seek causal explanation for conduct and character	FACT: Jaina action and moral consequence (karma) is subtle moral matter tied to liberation, not value-neutral brain mechanism

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

7E. DIRECTIVE DECODER ANALYSIS:

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Jainism answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	FACT: Breadth plus coherence	Define doctrine -> explain mechanics -> add one debate	ANALYSIS: "Thus Jainism offers a coherent pluralist realism, though its metaphysical costs remain."
Examine	FACT: Doctrinal accuracy	Break into components: substance (dravya), naya, syāt, action and moral consequence (karma), liberation (mokṣa)	ANALYSIS: "The doctrine is intelligible when its presuppositions are made explicit."
Critically examine	FACT: Doctrine plus objections	Present Śaṃkara/Nyāya/Buddhist objections and Jaina replies	ANALYSIS: "The reply is strong internally but not neutral across all schools."
Analyse	FACT: Internal logic	Show cause-effect links: metaphysics -> epistemology -> language -> liberation	ANALYSIS: "Its strength lies in systematic interconnection."
Evaluate	FACT: Balanced judgement	State strengths, weaknesses, and residual contestation	ANALYSIS: "Persuasive as qualified realism; vulnerable on material action and moral consequence (karma) and omniscience."
Compare	FACT: Inter-school positioning	Use axes: self, causation, means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), action and moral consequence (karma), liberation (mokṣa)	ANALYSIS: "The comparison shows Jainism as a middle path between flux and static permanence."
Distinguish	FACT: Conceptual precision	Use tables: many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)/qualified assertion (syādvāda)/sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī); bhāva/substance (dravya) bondage (bandha)	ANALYSIS: "The distinction prevents common UPSC conflation."
Elucidate	FACT: Clear explanation with examples	Define -> give example -> link to soteriology	ANALYSIS: "The example reveals the doctrinal logic, not merely illustration."
Comment	FACT: Short evaluative insight	State thesis and one philosophical implication	ANALYSIS: "The comment should be pointed, not a full survey."
Bring out	FACT: Hidden relation	Show how reality is reflected in judgement or action and moral consequence (karma) in liberation	ANALYSIS: "The relation is constitutive, not accidental."
Do you agree?	FACT: Reasoned stance	Agree partly -> give doctrine -> objections -> qualified verdict	ANALYSIS: "Agree within Jaina presuppositions; qualify from rival standpoints."

7F. GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM ANALYSIS:

Strong FACT:

1. FACT: Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.
2. FACT: Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda), standpoint analysis (nayavāda), and qualified assertion (syādvāda) form a disciplined sequence from ontology to epistemology to language.
3. FACT: Its material action and moral consequence (karma) doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.
4. FACT: Its ahiṃsā follows directly from plural conscious soul (jīvas) and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

Weak ANALYSIS:

1. ANALYSIS: Material action and moral consequence (karma) binding a conscious soul remains difficult for non-Jaina metaphysics.
2. ANALYSIS: Omniscience and higher direct knowledges are hard to verify externally.
3. ANALYSIS: The system can seem over-taxonomic in karma-types, guṇasthānas, and nayas.

4. ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified qualified assertion (syādvāda) may appear to weaken its own universal claim.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

1. CAUTION: Sectarian nuances about kāla's substantial independence differ in presentation.
2. CAUTION: Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.
3. CAUTION: Historical dating of several Jaina thinkers should not be asserted unless separately verified.

Ready verdicts. ANALYSIS:

- **10 marks:** Jainism is a pluralistic realism that avoids both pure permanence and pure flux by making every real a unity of substance (dravya) and mode (paryāya).
- **15 marks:** Its genius lies in connecting many-sided reality with conditional judgement, but its material action and moral consequence (karma) and omniscience doctrines remain philosophically contestable.
- **20 marks:** Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism: internally systematic, ethically powerful, and logically subtle, though vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction, and unverifiable higher knowledge.

8. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.
2019	Q6(a)	20 marks	How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.
2020	Q5(a)	10 marks	Examine the concept of Action and moral consequence (karma) according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?
2021	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'.
2022	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Jaina view of Action and moral consequence (karma) bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.
2022	Q6(b)	15 marks	'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.
2023	Q5(a)	10 marks	"All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.
2024	Q6(c)	15 marks	What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha and Dravyabandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.
2025	Q7(c)	15 marks	Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) ANALYSIS:

EXAM-READY LINE: Final verdict: Jaina philosophy combines metaphysical pluralism, perspectival logic and ethical self-purification, but its coherence depends on showing that conditional predication preserves truth without collapsing into contradiction or relativism.

9.1 10-mark answer

Define the key term precisely: many-sided reality (anekāntavāda), qualified assertion (syādvāda), action and moral consequence (karma), or bhāvabandha.

Give the doctrinal core in 3-4 compact points.

Add one distinction that prevents confusion (e.g., anekāntavāda vs syādvāda).

Close with one evaluative line or exam-relevant implication.

9.2 15-mark answer

Frame the issue: Jainism balances realism with non-absolutism.

Body A: explain the doctrine requested (reality / sevenfold judgement / bondage).

Body B: add structure-tables, ordered seven predicates, or bondage sequence.

Body C: include one criticism and one reply.

Conclude with a clear philosophical verdict, not mere summary.

9.3 20-mark answer

Open by linking metaphysics and judgement: many-sided reality requires qualified predication.

Section 1: define reality via substance (dravya), quality (guṇa), mode (paryāya), utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya.

Section 2: show reflection in standpoint analysis (nayavāda), qualified assertion (syādvāda), sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī).

Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, action and moral consequence (karma), and liberation.

Section 4: critically assess pluralism, realism, and self-refutation objections.

End with a balanced conclusion: realism without dogmatism.

10. LINK-OUTS

- Carvaka.md
- Buddhism.md
- Vedanta.md
- Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) across schools
- Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique
- Indian Philosophy PYQ bank, 2018-2025

SOURCES

- *Tattvārthasūtra* / *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* (named without invented sūtra numbers).
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The complete 2018-2025 route contains **nine verified topic-owned questions**. Match each question to its centre of gravity:

- Reality and judgement: 2019.
- Action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation: 2020 and 2022.
- Sevenfold judgement: 2021 and 2023.
- Absolutism objection: 2022.
- Bound/liberated soul and bondage: 2018 and 2024.
- Pluralism and realism: 2025.

Use the answer architectures and directive decoder in the retained source material below. The full model solutions, MCQs and original practice follow immediately after the layered teaching.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall - final master matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya</i>
Ontology	six <i>substance (dravyas)</i> ; five <i>astikāyas</i> plus time
Logic	<i>many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)</i> -> <i>naya</i> -> <i>syāt</i> -> <i>seven bhaṅgas</i>
Bondage	passion -> <i>bhāvabandha</i> -> <i>dravyabandha</i>
Release	<i>influx of karmic matter (āsrava)</i> -> <i>bondage (bandha)</i> -> <i>stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)</i> -> <i>shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)</i> -> <i>liberation (mokṣa)</i>
Path	right vision + right knowledge + right conduct
Verdict	pluralistic realism with qualified predication

Complete the integrated and remedial MCQs in the practice section before using the final consolidated register notes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS contradiction objection · relativism objection · same respect · place	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The operative mechanism is that jaina reply. FACT: FACT: Opposed predicates are	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Jaina reply. FACT: The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism,
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina qualification avoids contradiction by indexing opposed			

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]

Attempt each item before reading its key. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed. across all forty-eight diagnostics.

CORE DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

1. Which statement most accurately identifies the place of the Tattvārthasūtra in Jaina philosophy?

A. It is a systematic Sanskrit exposition attributed to Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī and accepted as authoritative by both major sects. B. It is chiefly a biography of Mahāvīra with no systematic metaphysics. C. It is a Śvetāmbara canonical Āgama rejected by all Digambaras. D. It establishes a creator God as the source of action and moral consequence (karma).

Answer: A. It is a systematic Sanskrit exposition attributed to Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī and accepted as authoritative by both major sects.

The text supplies a shared doctrinal grammar for knowledge, reality, action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation despite sectarian differences elsewhere. It presents the ratnatraya and major metaphysical categories. Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers, not creator Gods.

2. Which is a real substance (dravya) but not an astikāya?

A. Conscious soul (jīva) B. Kāla C. Dharma D. Ākāśa

Answer: B. Kāla

Jainism recognises six substance (dravyas) but only five astikāyas. Conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa possess extension through many pradeśas; kāla accounts for succession and change but is not an astikāya.

3. In the formula utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktaṃ sat, the real is characterised by:

A. creation, preservation and destruction by God. B. substance, universal and inherence. C. origination, decay and persistence together. D. momentary arising without an enduring aspect.

Answer: C. origination, decay and persistence together.

Jaina realism preserves both identity and change. A mode originates and another ceases while the substance (dravya) persists. The formula therefore resists both pure flux and an absolutely changeless reality.

4. Which option correctly states the relation among substance (dravya), quality (guṇa) and mode (paryāya)?

A. Quality (guṇa) and mode (paryāya) are interchangeable names for momentary events. B. Substance (dravya) is unreal, while qualities (guṇas) alone exist. C. Mode (paryāya) is permanent, while substance (dravya) arises and ceases. D. Substance (dravya) is substance, qualities (guṇas) are abiding qualities, and paryāyas are changing modes.

Answer: D. Substance (dravya) is substance, qualities (guṇas) are abiding qualities, and paryāyas are changing modes.

The distinction explains permanence-in-change. Qualities belong to a substance as characteristic features, while modes are its variable manifestations. Jaina many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) depends on this structured complexity.

5. Which list contains exactly the five astikāyas?

A. Conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa B. Conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, ākāśa, kāla and liberation (mokṣa) C. Pudgala, kāla, puṇya, pāpa and ākāśa D. Conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha) and liberation (mokṣa)

Answer: A. Conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa

These five are extended substances. Kāla completes the six-dravya scheme but not the pañcāstikāya scheme. The remaining distractors mix ontological substances with soteriological categories.

6. Dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya respectively mean:

A. right conduct and wrong conduct. B. media enabling motion and rest. C. moral merit and moral demerit. D. activity and cessation of activity.

Answer: B. media enabling motion and rest.

They are enabling conditions, not forces that push or stop objects and not ethical merit or sin. The moral reading is a standard factual trap produced by the ordinary meanings of *dharma* and *adharma*.

7. Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of conscious soul (jīva)?

A. It is ultimately identical with one universal Brahman. B. It is a temporary bundle of five aggregates. C. It is an individual conscious substance whose intrinsic capacities are obscured by action and moral consequence (karma). D. It is a property generated by a sufficiently organised body.

Answer: C. It is an individual conscious substance whose intrinsic capacities are obscured by action and moral consequence (karma).

Jainism affirms infinitely many beginningless conscious soul (jīvas). Consciousness is intrinsic, not adventitious. Bondage obscures infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power without destroying the soul's numerical identity.

8. Which feature uniquely marks pudgala among the six substance (dravyas)?

A. It alone enables motion. B. It alone is not real. C. It alone is conscious. D. It alone possesses rūpa and includes karmic matter.

Answer: D. It alone possesses rūpa and includes karmic matter.

Pudgala is material, form-bearing, divisible and aggregative. Bodies, sense-objects and subtle karma-pudgala belong to it. This makes Jaina bondage literally psychophysical rather than merely metaphorical.

9. In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is:

A. mediated cognition, though conventionally called empirical perception (pratyakṣa). B. rejected as intrinsically false. C. the highest form of unmediated perception (pratyakṣa). D. identical with perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna).

Answer: A. mediated cognition, though conventionally called empirical perception (pratyakṣa).

Strict directness is freedom from sense-and-mind mediation. Ordinary seeing is *sāmvyavahārika* perception (*pratyakṣa*) in practical usage but falls under mediated mati-jñāna in the higher classification. This is the Jaina

“perception (pratyakṣa) inversion.”

10. Which pair is correctly classified as parokṣa in the basic five-jñāna scheme?

A. Śruta and kevala B. Mati and śruta C. Avadhi and manaḥparyāya D. Mati and avadhi

Answer: B. Mati and śruta

Mati depends on senses and mind; śruta depends on signs, language and prior cognition. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are direct in the strict sense because they transcend ordinary sensory-mental mediation.

11. Which is the correct ascending sequence of the five kinds of Jaina knowledge?

A. Avadhi, mati, manaḥparyāya, śruta, kevala B. Mati, avadhi, śruta, kevala, manaḥparyāya C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala D. Śruta, mati, kevala, avadhi, manaḥparyāya

Answer: C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala

The sequence runs from ordinary sensory-mental cognition and verbal knowledge to limited clairvoyance, direct knowledge of others' mental modes and finally unlimited omniscience. It maps progressive removal of cognitive obstruction.

12. Which statement about Jaina perception (pratyakṣa) is correct?

A. Kevala is indirect because it lacks sense-contact. B. Only sense-contact can generate direct knowledge. C. All five jñānas are equally direct. D. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are strict or pāramārthika perception (pratyakṣa).

Answer: D. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are strict or pāramārthika perception (pratyakṣa).

The Jaina criterion is unmediated manifestation of the soul's cognition, not Nyāya-style sense-object contact. Avadhi and manaḥparyāya remain limited; only perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is unlimited.

13. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is primarily the doctrine that:

A. reality is objectively many-sided and no finite unqualified proposition exhausts it. B. only linguistic differences generate plurality. C. reality is an indescribable illusion. D. every belief is equally true because truth is subjective.

Answer: A. reality is objectively many-sided and no finite unqualified proposition exhausts it.

Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is first a metaphysical thesis, not a slogan of tolerance or scepticism. Multiple aspects belong to the object; finite cognition apprehends them partially. This objective basis separates Jaina perspectivism from subjectivism.

14. Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) explains:

A. the destruction of eight karmas. B. how partial standpoints can yield conditioned truths. C. the five ascetic vows. D. seven ontological substances.

Answer: B. how partial standpoints can yield conditioned truths.

A naya selects an aspect of a many-sided real. Partiality is not falsehood; error arises when a partial standpoint claims exhaustive status. Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) is thus epistemic, whereas many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is ontological.

15. Qualified assertion (syādvāda) is best described as:

A. the taxonomy of seven epistemic standpoints. B. the denial that propositions can be true. C. conditional predication through the operator syāt. D. the doctrine that only omniscience is knowledge.

Answer: C. conditional predication through the operator syāt.

Syāt means “in some respect” or “from a certain standpoint.” It makes language register the conditions under which a proposition is true and prevents a finite assertion from becoming ekāntic or one-sided.

16. Which formula correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

A. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = language; standpoint analysis (nayavāda) = matter; qualified assertion (syādvāda) = liberation. B. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = seven predicates; standpoint analysis (nayavāda) = seven principles (tattvas); qualified assertion (syādvāda) = seven vows. C. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = scepticism; standpoint analysis (nayavāda) = omniscience; qualified assertion (syādvāda) = ethics. D. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = many-sided reality; standpoint analysis (nayavāda) = standpoint-theory; qualified assertion (syādvāda) = qualified assertion.

Answer: D. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) = many-sided reality; standpoint analysis (nayavāda) = standpoint-theory; qualified assertion (syādvāda) = qualified assertion.

The doctrines form a dependence chain rather than synonyms. Ontological complexity limits finite cognition to standpoints, and standpoint-conditioned cognition requires qualified language.

17. Which is the correct first member of the seven nayas?

A. Naigama naya B. Verbal testimony (śabda) naya C. Evambhūta naya D. Ṛjusūtra naya

Answer: A. Naigama naya

The seven nayas are naigama, saṃgraha, vyavahāra, ṛjusūtra, verbal testimony (śabda), samabhirūḍha and evambhūta. Naigama is the common, purposive or unspecialised practical standpoint.

18. Which option correctly pairs a naya with its characteristic emphasis?

A. Evambhūta-generic class-character B. Ṛjusūtra-the present-state or momentary standpoint C. Saṃgraha-only the present moment D. Vyavahāra-strict etymological derivation

Answer: B. Ṛjusūtra-the present-state or momentary standpoint

Saṃgraha stresses generic class-character; vyavahāra concerns practical particulars; samabhirūḍha is etymologically discriminating; evambhūta applies a word when its relevant function is actually being performed.

19. Which statement correctly distinguishes seven nayas from seven bhāṅgas?

A. Nayas apply only to monks, whereas bhāṅgas apply only to householders. B. Both are identical enumerations with different spellings. C. Nayas classify standpoints, whereas bhāṅgas classify conditioned predication forms. D. Nayas are karmic stages; bhāṅgas are forms of knowledge.

Answer: C. Nayas classify standpoints, whereas bhāṅgas classify conditioned predication forms.

The seven nayas concern ways of approaching an object-generic, practical, temporal and linguistic. The seven bhāṅgas are combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under *syāt*.

20. What is the correct fourth bhāṅga?

A. *syād asti ca avaktavyam* B. *syād asti ca nāsti ca* C. *syād nāsti* D. *syād avaktavyam*

Answer: D. *syād avaktavyam**

The sequence begins affirmation, negation, both, and then inexpressibility. The fifth, sixth and seventh combine *avaktavya* respectively with affirmation, negation, and both.

21. In sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī), avaktavya chiefly signifies:

A. the inability of one simple unqualified utterance to express complex indexed aspects simultaneously. B. that the object is absolutely unknowable. C. that silence itself causes liberation. D. that every proposition is meaningless.

Answer: A. the inability of one simple unqualified utterance to express complex indexed aspects simultaneously.

Inexpressibility is semantic-modal, not nihilistic or merely psychological. A thing can be knowable under distinct aspects even when their temporally or modally complex conjunction cannot be stated in one simple assertion.

22. “In some respect, the jar is and is not” avoids formal contradiction if:

A. one of the two predicates is secretly false. B. affirmation and negation are indexed to different respects, times, places or modes. C. the jar is treated as imaginary. D. both predicates are asserted without qualification at the same time.

Answer: B. affirmation and negation are indexed to different respects, times, places or modes.

The law of non-contradiction forbids P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect and time. Jaina predication deliberately changes the index; suppressing the index produces the caricature of contradiction.

23. The standard self-refutation objection to many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) argues that:

A. many-sided objects cannot have qualities. B. only a creator God can know all sides. C. if all claims are qualified, many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) must either qualify itself or violate its own rule. D. action and moral consequence (karma) cannot explain rebirth.

Answer: C. if all claims are qualified, many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) must either qualify itself or violate its own rule.

If unqualified, the doctrine appears absolutist; if qualified, critics say it loses universal force. The Jaina reply is reflexive qualification: the doctrine rejects finite one-sided exhaustiveness, not objective truth or graded comprehensiveness.

24. Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism necessarily presupposes crude absolutism?

A. No proposition has any truth. B. Contradictions are always acceptable. C. Every standpoint is equally complete. D. Finite judgements are standpoint-bound, while perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) represents comprehensive cognition.

Answer: D. Finite judgements are standpoint-bound, while perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) represents comprehensive cognition.

Jainism distinguishes epistemic levels. It can affirm the objective many-sidedness of reality while denying that an ordinary unqualified claim exhausts it. The residual burden is independently supporting omniscience rather than merely postulating it to rescue the theory.

25. Which statement best captures Jaina action and moral consequence (karma)?

A. It is subtle material pudgala that binds the passion-affected soul. B. It is identical with Mīmāṃsā apūrva. C. It is divine reward and punishment. D. It is only the memory of previous actions.

Answer: A. It is subtle material pudgala that binds the passion-affected soul.

Jaina action and moral consequence (karma) is literally material, though extremely subtle. Psychic states attract and fix it to conscious soul (jīva). This differs from an unseen moral potency, a mere psychological disposition or a divine ledger.

26. Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage?

A. Bhāvabandha is bodily bondage; dravyabandha is verbal error. B. Bhāvabandha is psychic passion and delusion; dravyabandha is material karmic adhesion. C. Bhāvabandha is liberation; dravyabandha is omniscience. D. Bhāvabandha stops action and moral consequence (karma); dravyabandha sheds it.

Answer: B. Bhāvabandha is psychic passion and delusion; dravyabandha is material karmic adhesion.

Bhāvabandha is the internal causal condition that makes the soul adhesive. Dravyabandha is the objective karmic result. The distinction joins moral psychology to a realist material mechanism.

27. Which set gives the four parameters of bondage (bandha)?

A. Conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), puṇya and pāpa B. Influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha), shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) and liberation (mokṣa) C. Primordial material nature (prakṛti), sthiti, anubhāga and pradeśa D. Darśana, knowledge (jñāna), cāritra and tapas

Answer: C. Primordial material nature (prakṛti), sthiti, anubhāga and pradeśa

They denote the type, duration, intensity and quantity of karmic bondage. Yoga chiefly determines type and quantity; kaṣāya chiefly determines duration and intensity.

28. Which pairing of bondage parameter and principal determinant is correct?

A. Sthiti-yoga only; primordial material nature (prakṛti)-kaṣāya only B. Sthiti-ākāśa; pradeśa-kāla C. Primordial material nature (prakṛti)-perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna); anubhāga-liberation (mokṣa) D. Primordial material nature (prakṛti) and pradeśa-yoga; sthiti and anubhāga-kaṣāya

Answer: D. Primordial material nature (prakṛti) and pradeśa-yoga; sthiti and anubhāga-kaṣāya

Activity brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and affects its type and amount. Passions make bondage durable and intense. Hence intention and affect modify the karmic consequence of outwardly similar actions.

29. Which list gives the seven principles (tattvas)?

A. Conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha), stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara), shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) and liberation (mokṣa) B. Ahiṁsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, aparigraha, tapas and liberation (mokṣa) C. Conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla and liberation (mokṣa) D. Maṭi, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala, puṇya and pāpa

Answer: A. Conscious soul (jīva), non-conscious reality (ajīva), influx of karmic matter (āsrava), bondage (bandha), stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara), shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) and liberation (mokṣa)

The list moves from the conscious and non-conscious poles to influx, binding, prevention, shedding and release. It is ontology organised for liberation rather than a neutral inventory.

30. The nine categories (padārthas) are:

A. the six substance (dravyas) plus the three jewels. B. the seven principles (tattvas) plus puṇya and pāpa. C. the five astikāyas plus four vows. D. the seven principles (tattvas) plus dharma and adharma.

Answer: B. the seven principles (tattvas) plus puṇya and pāpa.

The ninefold list makes moral valence explicit. Yet puṇya, though preferable to pāpa within cycle of rebirth (saṁsāra), still involves action and moral consequence (karma) and is not identical with liberation (mokṣa).

31. Which sequence correctly states the operational path from bondage to liberation?

A. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) -> influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> liberation (mokṣa) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) B. Bondage (bandha) -> liberation (mokṣa) -> influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) C. Influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa) D. Shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> bondage (bandha) -> influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> liberation (mokṣa) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara)

Answer: C. Influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa)

Influx of karmic matter (āsrava) is influx and bondage (bandha) is attachment. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) prevents new karmic inflow, while shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) removes accumulated action and moral consequence (karma). Liberation (mokṣa) follows only when karmic bondage is completely absent.

32. Which statement correctly distinguishes stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)?

A. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) is influx; shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) is adhesion. B. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) destroys the soul; shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) creates a new soul. C. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) produces merit; shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) produces demerit. D. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) stops new action and moral consequence (karma), whereas shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) sheds action and moral consequence (karma) already bound.

Answer: D. Stoppage of karmic influx (saṁvara) stops new action and moral consequence (karma), whereas shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) sheds action and moral consequence (karma) already bound.

The distinction expresses the preventive and purgative dimensions of Jaina practice. Closing an inlet does not remove sediment already deposited; both operations are required for liberation.

33. Which set contains only ghātiyā karmas?

A. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus C. Mohanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus D. Jñānāvaraṇīya, vedanīya, nāma and gotra

Answer: A. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya

These obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation/conduct and energy. They damage or veil the soul's essential capacities. Mohanīya is especially dangerous because delusion corrupts both vision and conduct.

34. Which set contains only aghātiyā karmas?

A. Vedanīya, mohanīya, antarāya and āyus B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus C. Nāma, gotra, jñānāvaraṇīya and darśanāvaraṇīya D. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya

Answer: B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus

They determine pleasure-pain, embodiment, status and lifespan without directly obscuring the soul's essential knowledge, perception, orientation and power. They remain after ghātiyā karmas are destroyed in the sayoga-kevalī.

35. Which stage correctly describes the sayoga-kevalī?

A. A liberated bodiless siddha beyond all activity B. A soul with false vision and no restraint C. An embodied omniscient arhat with activity and residual aghātiyā karmas D. A householder observing only partial vows

Answer: C. An embodied omniscient arhat with activity and residual aghātiyā karmas

Sayoga-kevalī is the thirteenth guṇasthāna. Ghātiyā karmas are destroyed, so omniscience manifests, but bodily, verbal and mental activity continues until the remaining embodiment-determining karmas approach exhaustion.

36. Ayoga-kevalī is:

A. the first stage of wrong vision. B. a condition of suppressed but undestroyed delusion. C. the stage where subtle greed alone remains. D. the final, momentary omniscient stage without activity immediately before siddhahood.

Answer: D. the final, momentary omniscient stage without activity immediately before siddhahood.

It is the fourteenth guṇasthāna. All yoga ceases; the remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted, after which the soul becomes a bodiless siddha. It should not be confused with final liberation itself.

37. The ratnatraya consists of:

A. Samyag-darśana, samyag-jñāna and samyak-cāritra B. Matī, śruta and kevala C. Influx of karmic matter (āsrava), stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) D. Ahimsā, satya and aparigraha

Answer: A. Samyag-darśana, samyag-jñāna and samyak-cāritra

Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct are mutually reinforcing dimensions of the path. Knowledge without conduct cannot halt karmic influx, while conduct without right orientation lacks soteriological direction.

38. Which is not one of the five mahāvratas?

A. Asteya B. Īśvara-praṇidhāna C. Aparigraha D. Ahimsā

Answer: B. Īśvara-praṇidhāna

The five are ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya and aparigraha. Devotion to a creator Lord is not included; Jainism is non-theistic regarding cosmic creation.

39. Which statement best explains "liberation by subtraction" in Jainism?

A. Liberation (mokṣa) creates consciousness in a previously unconscious soul. B. The soul is subtracted from existence. C. Removal of karmic obstruction manifests the soul's intrinsic infinite capacities. D. Liberation adds divine grace to an incomplete conscious soul (jīva).

Answer: C. Removal of karmic obstruction manifests the soul's intrinsic infinite capacities.

Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) and the ananta-catuṣṭaya are revealed rather than manufactured. Purification radically changes the soul's modes while preserving the numerical identity of the substance (dravya).

40. Which is the most defensible overall classification of Jaina philosophy?

A. Subjective idealism with ethical conventionalism B. Absolute monism with an illusory world C. Nihilism combined with linguistic scepticism D. Pluralistic realism combined with epistemic non-absolutism

Answer: D. Pluralistic realism combined with epistemic non-absolutism

Jainism affirms many independent substances, many souls and a mind-independent world. Finite knowledge is standpoint-conditioned, but the object is not made unreal by that limitation. This formulation also fits the 2025 “pluralistic and realistic” directive.

REMEDIAL DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

41. Which statement about *sallekhanā* is doctrinally safest?

A. It is a carefully regulated, passionless thinning of body and attachment at an appropriate end of life, not impulsive suicide. B. It is a sacrifice offered to a creator God. C. It aims to destroy the soul along with the body. D. It is mandatory self-killing for every lay follower.

Answer: A. It is a carefully regulated, passionless thinning of body and attachment at an appropriate end of life, not impulsive suicide.

The decisive factors are intention, terminal context, equanimity and absence of passion. It must not be romanticised or treated as an ordinary escape from distress; its doctrinal defence rests on non-attachment and karmic purification.

42. Śaṃkara's central criticism of many-sided reality (*anekāntavāda*) is that:

A. material action and moral consequence (karma) requires a creator God. B. opposed predicates threaten contradiction and the doctrine faces a self-reference dilemma. C. liberation cannot preserve individuality. D. Jainism accepts too few substances.

Answer: B. opposed predicates threaten contradiction and the doctrine faces a self-reference dilemma.

Śaṃkara presses both logical consistency and assertoric force: if many-sided reality (*anekāntavāda*) is absolute, it violates itself; if merely conditional, it may fail to govern discourse. Jainism replies through indexed predicates and reflexive qualification.

43. Which named criticism-reply pair is correctly matched?

A. Rāmānuja: no object has qualities; reply: momentariness B. Cārvāka: a permanent soul cannot act; reply: *apūrva* C. Dharmakīrti/Buddhist: a permanent-yet-changing soul faces the causal-efficacy dilemma; reply: permanence as substance (*dravya*) and change as mode (*pariāya*) D. Nyāya: all objects are empty; reply: dependent origination

Answer: C. Dharmakīrti/Buddhist: a permanent-yet-changing soul faces the causal-efficacy dilemma; reply: permanence as substance (*dravya*) and change as mode (*pariāya*)

The Jaina response invokes *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*. Its force depends on accepting a real substance-mode distinction; a Buddhist who denies enduring substance will remain unconvinced.

44. What is the strongest residual philosophical difficulty in the doctrine of material action and moral consequence (karma)?

A. It requires an eternal creator. B. It makes ethical conduct irrelevant. C. It cannot distinguish good and bad actions. D. The interaction between conscious soul (*jīva*) and material karma-pudgala remains obscure.

Answer: D. The interaction between conscious soul (*jīva*) and material karma-pudgala remains obscure.

Jainism invokes the conscious soul (*jīva*)'s *pradeśas*, embodiment and passion-generated adhesiveness, but critics argue that the causal bridge still requires explanation. A strong answer should present the internal mechanism and preserve this residual objection.

45. In a PYQ asking “How does action and moral consequence (karma) bear upon soteriology?”, which answer-plan best follows the directive?

A. Define material action and moral consequence (karma), trace influx of karmic matter (*āsrava*)-bondage (*bandha*)-stoppage of karmic influx (*saṃvara*)-shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (*nirjarā*)-liberation (*mokṣa*), connect practices to each stage, then evaluate the mechanism. B. Compare every Indian school without explaining Jaina action and moral consequence (karma). C. Discuss only the seven *nayas* and omit liberation. D. Narrate Mahāvīra's life and list pilgrimage centres.

Answer: A. Define material action and moral consequence (karma), trace influx of karmic matter (*āsrava*)-bondage (*bandha*)-stoppage of karmic influx (*saṃvara*)-shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (*nirjarā*)-liberation (*mokṣa*), connect practices to each stage, then evaluate the mechanism.

“Bear upon” tests causal dependence, not independent notes on action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation (mokṣa). The answer must show how the ontology of karmic matter determines both the disciplines of prevention/shedding and the final condition of the soul.

46. Which statement is a factual trap?

A. Puṇya and pāpa are added to seven principles (tattvas) in the nine-padārtha list. B. Puṇya is identical with liberation (mokṣa) because all good action and moral consequence (karma) liberates permanently. C. Both puṇya and pāpa involve karmic determination. D. Puṇya may improve one’s saṃsāric condition.

Answer: B. Puṇya is identical with liberation (mokṣa) because all good action and moral consequence (karma) liberates permanently.

Merit is preferable to demerit but remains karmic involvement and can yield favourable rebirth rather than final release. Liberation (mokṣa) requires transcendence of all action and moral consequence (karma), pleasant as well as painful.

47. Which statement about the fourteen guṇasthānas is correct?

A. They describe cosmological substances rather than spiritual development. B. Every stage is attained at the instant of right vision. C. They mark graded purification from mithyā-dṛṣṭi through sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī toward liberation. D. They are seven linguistic standpoints doubled.

Answer: C. They mark graded purification from mithyā-dṛṣṭi through sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī toward liberation.

The scheme makes spiritual progress gradual and karmically analysable. Delusion may be suppressed at stage eleven and destroyed at stage twelve; omniscience with activity appears at thirteen and without activity at fourteen.

48. Which concluding sentence best answers “Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss”?

A. Jainism is realistic only about matter, not souls or modes. B. Jainism is monistic because all liberated souls merge. C. Jainism is relativist, so it denies every objective object. D. Jainism is pluralistic realism with standpoint-conditioned finite knowledge, though substance-mode unity and omniscience remain contested.

Answer: D. Jainism is pluralistic realism with standpoint-conditioned finite knowledge, though substance-mode unity and omniscience remain contested.

The sentence answers both classificatory terms, distinguishes ontology from epistemology and preserves a critical remainder. It avoids the false inference that qualified judgement entails idealism or scepticism.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQS - 9 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

The following are independent practice models prepared from the verified question corpus and Jaina doctrine. They are not official UPSC answer keys.

2018 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Explain the mechanism of bondage, not merely define action and moral consequence (karma).
- Compare the bound and liberated soul on identity, embodiment, cognition and destiny.
- State positively what remains after liberation.
- “Discuss” requires one conceptual difficulty and a balanced conclusion.

Independent model answer

Jainism explains bondage as the beginningless but terminable association of conscious **conscious soul (jīva)** with subtle material **karma-pudgala**. The soul is intrinsically capable of infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss,

yet activity of body, speech and mind (**yoga**), when coloured by delusion and the passions of anger, pride, deceit and greed, attracts karmic matter.

Bondage has two inseparable dimensions. **Bhāvabandha** is psychic bondage: the soul's wrong vision, attachment, aversion and passion make it "adhesive." **Dravyabandha** is the consequent material attachment of karmic particles. The process may be mapped as **influx of karmic matter (āsrava)** (influx) -> **bondage (bandha)** (adhesion). Its reversal requires **stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)**, which stops fresh influx, and **shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)**, which sheds accumulated action and moral consequence (karma).

Bound soul	Liberated soul
Embodied and co-extensive with its body	Bodiless siddha
Knowledge and perception obscured	Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) and perfect perception manifest
Subject to pleasure, pain, birth and death	Beyond suffering and rebirth
Conditioned by all eight karma-prakṛtis	Entirely free from karmic matter
Moves through cycle of rebirth (saṃsāra)	Abides at siddha-śīlā

The liberated soul does not merge into Brahman and is not annihilated. It retains numerical individuality while manifesting the **ananta-catuṣṭaya**-infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power. Liberation is thus purification of an enduring individual, achieved through the ratnatraya of right vision, right knowledge and right conduct.

The theory preserves moral agency and personal continuity without a creator God. Its residual difficulty is explaining how conscious soul (jīva) and material action and moral consequence (karma) interact. Nevertheless, within Jaina pluralistic realism, bondage is a real psychophysical entanglement and liberation (mokṣa) its complete removal.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2018 · Q6(c) · 15 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Answers all three limbs of the question in separate, connected moves.
- Distinguishes bhāvabandha from dravyabandha instead of treating bondage generically.
- Uses the complete influx of karmic matter (āsrava)-bondage (bandha)-stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)-shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) route.
- Compares bound and liberated souls across five examinable dimensions.
- Avoids the Advaita trap of merger and the Buddhist trap of self-extinction.
- Adds a precise interaction objection without displacing doctrinal exposition.

2019 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Define reality through the Jaina formula of permanence-in-change.
- Explain substance (dravya), quality (guṇa), mode (paryāya) and many-sided reality (anekāntavāda).
- Derive standpoint analysis (nayavāda), qualified assertion (syādvāda) and sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) from that ontology.
- "Discuss" requires illustration, criticism, reply and a qualified verdict.

Independent model answer

Jainism defines the real as that which possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay) and **dhrauvya** (persistence): *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktam sat*. Pure permanence cannot explain experienced change, while pure flux cannot explain identity. A real therefore persists as **substance (dravya)**, possesses abiding **qualities (guṇas)**, and changes through **paryāyas**.

This ontology is irreducibly plural. The six substance (dravyas) are conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla. Five are astikāyas; kāla is a substance (dravya) but not an astikāya. A gold ornament illustrates the formula: gold persists, bracelet-mode ceases and ring-mode originates. Because every real contains multiple objective aspects, reality is **many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)**, non-one-sided.

The theory of judgement follows from this metaphysics. Finite knowers normally apprehend an object under a partial **naya** or standpoint. A naya is not false merely because partial; it becomes false when absolutised. **Qualified assertion (syādvāda)** therefore requires the operator *syāt*-“in some respect”-so that language records the conditions of truth. Its sevenfold elaboration is:

1. *syād asti*-in some respect it is;
2. *syād nāsti*-in some respect it is not;
3. *syād asti ca nāsti ca*-in different respects it is and is not;
4. *syād avaktavyam*-in some respect it is inexpressible;
5. *syād asti ca avaktavyam*;
6. *syād nāsti ca avaktavyam*;
7. *syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam*.

A jar exists here and now as a jar, does not exist as cloth or as a future destroyed jar, and is *avaktavya* when temporally and modally distinct determinations are demanded in one simple, simultaneous utterance. The scheme does not affirm P and not-P in the same respect, place, time and mode.

Śaṃkara objects that opposed predicates destroy determinate knowledge and that many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) either asserts itself absolutely or loses universal force. The Jaina reply indexes predication to **substance (dravya)**, **kṣetra**, **kāla** and **bhāva** and reflexively applies *syāt* to its own doctrine. Moreover, finite judgement is standpoint-bound, whereas perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is comprehensive.

Thus Jaina judgement is not scepticism or subjective relativism. It is the linguistic discipline demanded by a pluralistic realism. Its strength is the reconciliation of identity, change and cognitive humility; its burden is independently justifying omniscience and the status of its own universal claims.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2019 · Q6(a) · 20 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Opens with the exact metaphysical formula and explains each term.
- Links substance (dravya)-quality (guṇa)-mode (paryāya) to many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) rather than listing doctrines.
- Derives judgement theory through the chain many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) -> naya -> syāt -> seven bhangas.
- Gives all seven predications in the correct order.
- Uses a worked object-example and the conditions blocking contradiction.
- Engages Śaṃkara and ends with a genuinely critical verdict.

2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Examine the concept of Action and moral consequence (karma) according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?

Demand decoding

- Identify what is distinctive about Jain action and moral consequence (karma).
- Show its causal relation to bondage and liberation.
- “Examine” requires a compact conceptual assessment, not only description.

Independent model answer

Jainism treats action and moral consequence (karma) not merely as moral law, merit-demerit or unseen potency, but as subtle **material pudgala**. Activity of body, speech and mind produces **influx of karmic matter (āsrava)**, while delusion and the four **kaṣāyas**-anger, pride, deceit and greed-make the soul receptive to karmic matter. Its attachment is **bondage (bandha)**, which obscures the conscious soul (jīva)’s intrinsic knowledge, perception, energy and bliss.

This material conception directly structures liberation. The ratnatraya-right vision, right knowledge and right conduct-together with vows, restraint and austerity weakens passion. **Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)** prevents fresh influx; **shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)** exhausts previously accumulated action and moral consequence (karma). Destruction of the obscuring karmas manifests perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna), and destruction of every karmic residue yields liberation (mokṣa): the individual soul becomes a bodiless siddha.

Hence liberation is “by subtraction”: perfection is revealed when obstruction is removed, not bestowed by God or produced as a new essence. The doctrine unifies ethics and metaphysics through a precise causal mechanism. However, the interaction of material action and moral consequence (karma) with conscious soul (jīva) remains philosophically obscure, and beginningless bondage explains the absence of a first fall rather than its possibility.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Identifies action and moral consequence (karma) as material pudgala, the central factual discriminator.
- Connects yoga and kaṣāya to influx and adhesion.
- Explains both preventive and purgative sides of liberation.
- Uses the “liberation by subtraction” insight to answer “bear upon.”
- Includes one concise internal strength and one residual objection.

2021 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the Jain view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) ‘Naya’.

Demand decoding

- Clarify the relation among naya, syāt and sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī).
- State all seven predications exactly and in order.
- Explain avaktavya and answer the contradiction objection.

Independent model answer

The Jain sevenfold judgement is the formal expression of a many-sided reality. **Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)** is the metaphysical thesis that a real has multiple aspects; **standpoint analysis (nayavāda)** explains that finite cognition approaches it through partial standpoints; **qualified assertion (syādvāda)** requires each finite assertion to be qualified by syāt, “in some respect.” Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) is therefore not a list of seven nayas but a schema of seven conditioned predications.

1. **syād asti**-in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti**-in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca**-in different respects or successively, it is and is not.

4. **syād avaktavyam**-in some respect, it is inexpressible.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam**-it is and is inexpressible.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam**-it is not and is inexpressible.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam**-it is, is not and is inexpressible.

A jar exists as a present jar at a given place; it does not exist as cloth, elsewhere, or after destruction. It may be called inexpressible where a single unqualified utterance is asked to express jointly what belongs to different times, modes or relations. *Avaktavya* therefore does not mean sheer ignorance or mystical silence; it marks a limitation of simple simultaneous predication.

Critics such as Śaṃkara and Rāmānuja argue that “is” and “is not” threaten non-contradiction. The Jaina reply is that contradiction arises only when opposed predicates attach in the same respect, place, time and mode. *Syāt* expressly prevents that collapse.

Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) is consequently neither seven truth-values nor unrestricted relativism. It is a discipline for expressing objective but aspect-conditioned truths. Its success depends, however, on making the relevant qualifications explicit rather than using *syāt* as a merely decorative hedge.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2021 · Q7(c) · 15 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Separates the seven standpoints from the seven predication forms.
- Reproduces all seven bhaṅgas accurately and sequentially.
- Gives *avaktavya* a semantic-modal, not mystical, meaning.
- Applies the doctrine to a single coherent example.
- Presents the named contradiction criticism and the indexed Jaina reply.

2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

Question: How does Jaina view of Action and moral consequence (karma) bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Focus on how the action and moral consequence (karma) doctrine determines the path and goal.
- Link material action and moral consequence (karma) to ethical discipline and liberation.
- “Critically discuss” requires a balanced evaluative close.

Independent model answer

Jaina soteriology is unintelligible without its distinctive doctrine of action and moral consequence (karma) as subtle **pudgala**. The conscious soul (jīva) is intrinsically capable of infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, but passion-coloured activity attracts karmic particles that obscure these capacities. Bondage is thus real material accretion, not merely guilt, memory or divine punishment.

The path directly reverses this mechanism: **influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa)**. The three jewels orient the whole person; ahiṃsā, restraint and the vows reduce the activities and passions causing influx; austerity and equanimity shed old action and moral consequence (karma). When ghātiyā karmas are destroyed, perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) manifests in the embodied sayoga-kevalī; after the remaining aghātiyā karmas expire, the soul becomes an unembodied siddha.

The view powerfully integrates moral intention, conduct, cognition and embodiment without invoking creator-God or grace. Yet its literal materialism generates an interaction problem: how does conscious soul (jīva) attract and carry karmic matter? Therefore action and moral consequence (karma) gives Jaina soteriology exceptional causal

precision, but at a significant metaphysical cost.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Directly answers “bear upon” through a mechanism rather than a definition.
- Correctly distinguishes the kevalin stage from final siddhahood.
- Integrates ratnatraya, vows, stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā).
- Shows why the theory works without a creator God.
- Ends with a focused consciousness-matter criticism.

2022 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: ‘The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating ‘Absolutism’.’ Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.

Demand decoding

- Reconstruct the self-reference and universal-scope objection fairly.
- Test whether Jainism is crude relativism or realist non-absolutism.
- Give explicit reasons for a defended conclusion.

Independent model answer

The objection identifies a reflexive difficulty. If every proposition is only relatively true, then “every proposition is relative” is itself relative and cannot govern all judgements. If Jainism asserts many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) universally, it appears to make an absolute exception for itself. Further, doctrines such as real substance (dravyas), the soul’s intrinsic consciousness and perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) seem to claim more than local validity.

This criticism defeats the slogan “all views are equally true,” but that slogan is not classical Jainism. Jainism is a **realist non-absolutism**. Objects possess determinate, objective aspects; a naya is true when it tracks one such aspect and false when its partial truth is absolutised. *Syāt* indexes truth to substance, place, time and mode; it does not turn truth into subjective preference.

Jainism can also distinguish finite and perfect cognition. Ordinary knowledge is karmically limited and therefore aspectual. **Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)**, attained when cognitive obstructions are destroyed, apprehends all aspects. The minimum unconditional commitment is not “nothing is absolute,” but “no finite, unqualified standpoint exhausts a many-sided real.” This proposition can itself be reflexively qualified without becoming meaningless: from the standpoint of finite discourse, non-one-sided predication is rationally required.

Nevertheless, some absoluteness remains. The claim that reality has substance, qualities and modes is universal, while the postulate of omniscience requires independent defence. If invoked solely to guarantee the system, it risks circularity.

Therefore Jaina relativism cannot survive as total relativism; nor need it. The coherent doctrine is qualified pluralistic realism: objective reality, graded cognition and anti-absolutism concerning finite predication. It concedes a minimal framework of truth while rejecting one-sided claims to exhaustive truth.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2022 · Q6(b) · 15 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- States the self-reference objection in its strongest logical form.
- Distinguishes relativism, non-absolutism and objective standpoint-truth.
- Explains how perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) functions in the Jaina reply.
- Concedes the universal commitments and evidential burden instead of offering a defensive answer.
- Gives clear reasons for a nuanced verdict rather than a binary yes/no.

2023 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.

Demand decoding

- Evaluate, rather than simply accept, the quotation.
- Relate the Jaina classification of knowledge to sevenfold judgement.
- State the scope and limit of sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) concisely.

Independent model answer

Jainism agrees that ordinary embodied cognition is limited, but it does not accept that all knowledge is merely sensory-empirical. In its fivefold classification, **mati** and **śruta** are mediated or parokṣa knowledge. **Avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya** and **kevala** are direct in the strict Jaina sense because they are not mediated by ordinary senses and mind. Thus the proposition in the question is only partially Jaina.

Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) governs finite discursive judgement. A real combines enduring substance (dravya) and changing paryāyas; consequently a jar may be affirmed with respect to its own substance, place, time and mode, negated with respect to another, and called *avaktavya* when these indexed determinations cannot be expressed together in one simple utterance. The seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility prevent a partial judgement from claiming exhaustive truth.

Yet relativity is not universal scepticism. Nayas disclose objective aspects, and perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is held to be complete and non-relative. Critics may regard omniscience as an ad hoc exception; Jainism replies that it follows from removal of knowledge-obscuring action and moral consequence (karma).

Hence sevenfold judgement is a discipline for finite, conditioned assertion, not proof that every possible cognition is empirical or equally relative.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2023 · Q5(a) · 10 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Challenges the quotation through the Jaina perception (pratyakṣa)/parokṣa inversion.
- Correctly classifies all five jñānas.
- Explains the function of sevenfold judgement without wasting space listing all seven.
- Distinguishes objective partial truth from scepticism.
- Adds the precise perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) objection and reply.

2024 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is the distinction between Bhāva-bandha and Dravya-bandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Define both forms of bondage with doctrinal precision.
- Explain their causal relation and their place in the liberation sequence.
- "Discuss" warrants the four bondage (bandha) parameters and one critical issue.

Independent model answer

Jainism distinguishes the soul's psychic condition from the material result produced by it. **Bhāvabandha** is the bondage constituted by wrong vision, ignorance, attachment, aversion and the four kaṣāyas-anger, pride, deceit and greed. It is a modification of the conscious soul (jīva) that makes it receptive or "sticky." **Dravyabandha** is the actual association of subtle karma-pudgala with the soul.

The relation is causal:

mithyātvā + yoga + kaṣāya → bhāvabandha → influx of karmic matter (āsrava) → dravyabandha

Yoga, activity of body, speech and mind, brings karmic matter into relation with the soul. Passion fixes it deeply. Material bondage is further analysed through four parameters: **primordial material nature (prakṛti)** (type), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga/rasa** (intensity) and **pradeśa** (quantity). Yoga chiefly determines type and quantity; kaṣāya chiefly determines duration and intensity. Thus identical outward acts can have different karmic consequences according to inner passion.

The distinction also clarifies liberation. Right vision and passionless conduct transform the psychic condition and produce **stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)**, stopping new influx. Austerity and equanimity promote **shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā)**, the shedding of already bound material action and moral consequence (karma). Inner reform and material purification are therefore mutually necessary.

The theory avoids reducing bondage either to intention alone or to a mechanical physical event. However, it leaves a category-crossing difficulty: the causal bridge by which a conscious modification attracts material particles is asserted more clearly than it is explained.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2024 · Q6(c) · 15 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim → named evidence → analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Defines both terms and avoids reversing psychic cause and material result.
- Supplies a clear causal chain from mithyātvā and passion to material adhesion.
- Adds the four parameters of bondage (bandha) with their determinants.
- Shows how the distinction maps onto stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) and shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā).
- Gives a balanced assessment of the doctrine's explanatory gain and interaction problem.

2025 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Establish pluralism and realism separately with doctrinal evidence.
- Reconcile objective reality with standpoint-conditioned knowledge.
- Critically discuss objections to permanence-in-change and qualified predication.

Independent model answer

Jaina philosophy is **pluralistic** because it recognises infinitely many individual conscious soul (jīvas) and five irreducible kinds of non-conscious reality (ajīva), together forming six substance (dravyas): conscious soul (jīva), pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla. It rejects both a single universal self and reduction of consciousness to matter. Liberation too preserves a plurality of individual siddhas.

It is **realistic** because substances, qualities and modes exist independently of their being known. The external world is neither mental construction nor ultimately illusory. Each real possesses persistence as substance (dravya) and change through mode (paryāya); hence *sat* includes origination, decay and permanence. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) means that the object itself is many-sided, not merely that observers invent different descriptions.

Its epistemology qualifies, rather than abandons, realism. Nayas select objective aspects; qualified assertion (syādvāda) indexes assertions to respect, place, time and mode; sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) systematically combines affirmation, negation and inexpressibility. Truth is perspective-conditioned for finite knowers but not merely subjective.

Three objections remain. Śaṅkara argues that opposed predicates threaten non-contradiction; the Jaina reply separates their respects. A Buddhist critic rejects the enduring substance beneath changing modes; Jainism invokes *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*. The self-refutation objection asks whether many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) absolutises its own relativity; Jainism reflexively qualifies finite discourse and reserves comprehensive cognition for perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna).

Therefore Jainism is best described as **pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism**. Its ontology is robustly objective and irreducibly many; its principal burdens are defending the substance-mode distinction and independently grounding omniscience.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in 2025 · Q7(c) · 15 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Proves pluralism through many souls, six substance (dravyas) and non-merger in liberation.
- Proves realism through mind-independent substance (dravya)-quality (guṇa)-mode (paryāya).
- Explains why epistemic qualification does not entail ontological idealism.
- Uses three distinct criticisms with their Jaina replies.
- Ends with the most precise classificatory formula and its residual burdens.

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish many-sided reality (anekāntavāda), standpoint analysis (nayavāda) and qualified assertion (syādvāda), and show why they cannot be treated as synonyms.

Demand decoding

- Define each doctrine at its proper philosophical level.
- Establish their order of dependence.
- Use one example to show their coordinated operation.

Full answer

The three doctrines form a connected architecture, not three names for relativism. **Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)** is metaphysical: every real has multiple objective aspects because substance (dravya) persists while qualities (guṇas) and paryāyas provide complex, changing determinations. No finite unqualified proposition exhausts such a real.

Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) is epistemic. A finite knower approaches the many-sided object under a **naya**, a partial standpoint. The substantial standpoint may stress persistence, the modal standpoint change, and practical or linguistic standpoints other features. Partiality is legitimate; only its absolutisation becomes ekāntavāda.

Qualified assertion (syādvāda) is semantic-logical. Since a standpoint yields conditioned truth, assertion should bear *syāt*—"in some respect." This qualification is developed into sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī).

A gold bracelet makes the sequence clear. The real includes enduring gold and changing bracelet-mode. One standpoint stresses material continuity, another the produced form. "It exists" is true as this bracelet now; "it does not exist" is true as a ring or after remaking.

Thus ontology grounds standpoint, and standpoint grounds qualified speech. Treating the doctrines as synonyms erases Jainism's movement from reality to knowledge to language.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 1 · 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Defines all three doctrines without conceptual overlap.
- Shows the dependence chain explicitly.
- Uses substance (dravya) and mode (paryāya) to ground the explanation.
- Applies one example across all levels.
- Ends by identifying the precise consequence of conflation.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Why is the Jaina classification of perception (pratyakṣa) described as an "inversion" of ordinary epistemological usage? Examine.

Demand decoding

- State the strict Jaina criterion of directness.
- Classify the five jñānas correctly.
- Explain the philosophical function and one objection.

Full answer

Ordinary usage treats sense-perception as paradigmatically direct. Jainism "inverts" this expectation because strict **perception (pratyakṣa)** means cognition manifested by the soul without mediation by senses or mind. Seeing a jar is only **sāmvyavahārika perception (pratyakṣa)**, conventionally direct for practical purposes; doctrinally it belongs to mediated **mati-jñāna**.

The five jñānas reflect this criterion. **Mati** and **śruta** are parokṣa because they depend respectively on sensory-mental processes and signs or testimony. **Avadhi** is limited direct knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sensory range; **manaḥparyāya** directly grasps others' mental modes; **perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)** is unlimited, unmediated omniscience.

The classification links epistemology to soteriology. Directness increases as knowledge-obscuring action and moral consequence (karma) is removed, culminating in the soul's intrinsic cognition. It also explains why ordinary human judgements require standpoint analysis (nayavāda) and qualified assertion (syādvāda).

Nyāya may object that knowledge without sense-contact is not perceptual, while the higher jñānas lack ordinary verification. Jainism replies that metaphysical directness concerns absence of mediation, though the empirical objection to extraordinary cognition remains.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 2 · 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Identifies the exact criterion causing the inversion.
- Correctly classifies all five forms of knowledge.
- Links epistemology to karmic purification and conditional judgement.
- Introduces a named Nyāya objection.
- Gives a qualified rather than dogmatic conclusion.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Does sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) violate the law of non-contradiction? Critically examine.

Demand decoding

- State the logical test for contradiction.
- Examine the third and *avaktavya*-bearing bhangas.
- Present the classical objection, Jaina reply and residual condition of success.

Full answer

The law of non-contradiction prohibits asserting P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect, time and sense. Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) does not intend such an assertion. It combines affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syāt*, which indexes every claim to a standpoint.

The first two bhangas-*syād asti* and *syād nāsti*-affirm and deny under different conditions. A jar exists as this jar here and now; it does not exist as cloth, elsewhere, or after destruction. The third-*syād asti ca nāsti ca*-combines these judgements successively or under distinct respects, not as an unqualified simultaneous contradiction.

The fourth, *syād avaktavyam*, marks the inability of one simple utterance to express jointly a complex of differently indexed aspects. It does not mean that the object is unknowable. The remaining bhangas combine *avaktavya* with affirmation, negation, and both.

Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja object that if opposed attributes are genuinely real, shifting the standpoint only relocates rather than solves contradiction. The Jaina response invokes substance (dravya)-mode (paryāya): permanence belongs to the continuing substance, while origination and cessation belong to modes. The object is complex, but no identical predicate is both affirmed and denied under one index.

A further self-reference problem remains. If every assertion must be qualified, the sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) doctrine itself must be qualified. Jainism can accept this reflexively; it rejects finite one-sided exhaustiveness, not all determinate truth.

Therefore sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) is compatible with non-contradiction when indexes of substance, place, time and mode are explicit. It becomes incoherent only when *syāt* is reduced to a vague verbal hedge or opposed claims are made under the same conditions.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 3 · 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Begins with the formal condition for contradiction.
- Tests the most vulnerable third and fourth predications.
- Explains *avaktavya* with semantic precision.
- Names Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja and supplies the substance (dravya)-mode (paryāya) reply.
- Adds the self-reference issue and a conditional verdict.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Explain how the eight karma-prakṛtis and four parameters of bondage (bandha) deepen the Jaina account of moral responsibility.

Demand decoding

- Classify all eight karmas and state their functions.
- Explain the four dimensions of karmic binding and their determinants.
- Derive the account of responsibility from intention, passion and activity.

Full answer

Jainism deepens moral responsibility by treating action and moral consequence (karma) as subtle matter whose type and force vary with the agent's activity and passions. The eight **karma-prakṛtis** divide into two groups. The **ghātiyā** karmas are jñānāvaraṇīya, obscuring knowledge; darśanāvaraṇīya, obscuring perception; mohaniya, deluding vision and conduct; and antarāya, obstructing energy. The **aghātiyā** karmas are vedanīya, determining pleasure and pain; nāma, embodiment; gotra, status; and āyus, lifespan.

This taxonomy explains different dimensions of empirical limitation rather than attributing every consequence to an undifferentiated moral force. Mohaniya is especially decisive because delusion misorients both belief and conduct. Destruction of the four ghātiyā karmas yields the omniscient but embodied sayoga-kevalī; the aghātiyā karmas expire only before final siddhahood.

Each act also binds action and moral consequence (karma) under four parameters: **primordial material nature (prakṛti)** or type, **sthiti** or duration, **anubhāga** or intensity, and **pradeśa** or quantity. Yoga-the activity of body, speech and mind-chiefly determines type and quantity. Kaṣāya-anger, pride, deceit and greed-chiefly determines duration and intensity. Passionless activity therefore has a different karmic result from outwardly similar passion-coloured activity.

The framework joins external conduct to inner agency. It avoids reducing responsibility either to intention alone or to physical movement alone: action brings action and moral consequence (karma), while passion fixes it. Its strength is causal and ethical granularity. Its weakness is metaphysical elaborateness and the obscure interaction between conscious states and material particles.

Thus Jaina responsibility is neither divine judgement nor mechanical behaviourism. It is a psychophysical account in which what one does and how one inwardly does it jointly shape bondage.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 4 · 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Names and correctly classifies all eight karma-prakṛtis.
- Explains rather than merely lists what each class does.
- Gives all four bondage (bandha) parameters and their principal determinants.
- Derives a nuanced account of intention and action.
- Connects sayoga-kevalī to the ghātiyā/aghātiyā distinction.
- Balances explanatory richness against metaphysical cost.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Jaina liberation is purification in substance but transformation in mode." Analyse.

Demand decoding

- Interpret both halves through substance (dravya)-mode (paryāya) ontology.
- Reconstruct bondage, the path, perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) and final liberation (mokṣa).
- Explain continuity and change in the soul, with criticisms and a reasoned verdict.

Full answer

The statement applies Jaina ontology directly to soteriology. A real combines persistence and change: substance (dravya) endures while paryāyas originate and cease. The conscious soul (jīva) therefore remains numerically the

same substance through bondage and liberation, yet its modes and existential condition are radically transformed.

Purification is “in substance” because liberation does not manufacture a new self or merge many selves into one. Every conscious soul (jīva) is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, power and bliss. Empirical ignorance arises because subtle material action and moral consequence (karma) obscures these capacities. Removing action and moral consequence (karma) reveals what belongs to the soul; it does not replace its identity. In this sense liberation (mokṣa) is liberation by subtraction.

The process begins with passion-coloured yoga. Wrong vision and kaṣāya constitute bhāva-bandha; karmic influx and adhesion constitute dravya-bandha. The sequence is **influx of karmic matter (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) -> shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa)**. Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct provide orientation; the vows reduce harmful activity and attachment; austerity and equanimity shed old action and moral consequence (karma).

Transformation is nevertheless real at the level of modes. The bound conscious soul (jīva) is embodied, contracts or expands with its body, undergoes pleasure and pain and moves through rebirth. Progress through the fourteen guṇasthānas gradually removes delusion and passion. At stage thirteen, the sayoga-kevalī has destroyed the ghātiyā karmas and manifests omniscience while residual aghātiyā karmas sustain embodiment. At stage fourteen, activity ceases; after the remaining action and moral consequence (karma) is exhausted, the bodiless siddha abides at siddha-śilā, beyond rebirth.

The theory thus avoids two extremes. Against Advaita, liberation is not absorption into an undifferentiated absolute. Against Buddhist anātman, it is not release without an enduring self-substance. Yet critics ask how an intrinsically perfect soul could be beginninglessly obscured and how material action and moral consequence (karma) affects consciousness. Jainism answers that the conscious soul (jīva)-action and moral consequence (karma) relation is anādi but terminable and that embodied conscious soul (jīva) has pradeśas through which action and moral consequence (karma) associates with it. These replies preserve internal coherence but leave an interaction puzzle.

Therefore the quotation is accurate. Jaina liberation (mokṣa) preserves substantial identity while transforming every karmically conditioned mode. Purification and transformation are not rivals: the former explains continuity, the latter the radical difference between saṃsārīn and siddha.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 5 · 20 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Interprets the quotation through the central substance (dravya)-mode (paryāya) distinction.
- Reconstructs the complete bondage-and-release mechanism.
- Integrates ratnatraya, vows, eight karmas and guṇasthānas.
- Distinguishes sayoga-kevalī, ayoga-kevalī and siddha.
- Uses Advaita and Buddhism for controlled comparison.
- Ends with a synthesis that preserves both continuity and transformation.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Can Jaina pluralistic realism consistently sustain both epistemic humility and the claim to omniscience? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Establish the realist and pluralist ontology.
- Derive epistemic humility from finite cognition and standpoint theory.
- Test the compatibility and evidential burden of perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna).
- Reach a graded verdict rather than dismissing either side.

Full answer

Jainism is pluralistic because it accepts infinitely many conscious soul (jīvas) and five irreducible kinds of non-conscious reality (ajīva); it is realistic because substance (dravyas), qualities (guṇas) and paryāyas exist independently of cognition. Reality itself is **ananta-dharmātmaka**, possessed of indefinitely many aspects. Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) is therefore ontological complexity, not subjective construction.

Epistemic humility follows from the condition of the ordinary knower. Mati and śruta depend on senses, mind, signs and karmic limitation. Such cognition apprehends an aspect rather than the whole. Standpoint analysis (nayavāda) legitimises partial standpoints while warning against their absolutisation; qualified assertion (syādvāda) makes assertions conditional; sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) systematises affirmation, negation and inexpressibility. Humility is thus disciplined realism: one may know truly without knowing exhaustively.

At first, omniscience seems to threaten this architecture. If no assertion exhausts reality, how can a kevalin know all aspects? If Jainism invokes perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) to guarantee the truth of its system, the doctrine may become circular. A Cārvāka or modern empiricist will add that unlimited cognition lacks public verification.

The Jaina answer distinguishes finite discursivity from the intrinsic cognitive power of the purified soul. Mati and śruta are mediated; avadhi and manaḥparyāya show degrees of unmediated cognition; perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is complete manifestation after knowledge-obscuring action and moral consequence (karma) is destroyed.

Non-absolutism is therefore not the claim that exhaustive knowledge is impossible in principle. It is the claim that finite, karmically conditioned standpoints must not masquerade as such knowledge.

This reply has three strengths. First, it prevents humility from collapsing into scepticism: standpoints track objective aspects. Second, it gives soteriology an epistemic goal: purification enlarges cognition. Third, it allows the doctrine to explain its own possibility-comprehensive teaching ultimately rests on kevalin knowledge.

However, these strengths create burdens. The graded series from sensory cognition to omniscience does not by itself prove that the final term exists. Reflexively qualifying many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) preserves consistency but may weaken its universal authority. Further, if perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is non-discursive, its communication through language again enters partial standpoint-forms. The omniscient content may be complete while every transmitted proposition remains conditioned.

The most coherent interpretation therefore separates ontological, cognitive and linguistic levels. Reality is objectively many-sided; ordinary cognition is partial; perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is postulated as comprehensive; linguistic communication remains selective even when sourced in comprehensive cognition. On this reading, humility and omniscience are logically compatible but not evidentially equal.

Jainism can consistently sustain both claims because they concern different epistemic conditions. Yet consistency is not proof: omniscience remains the system's strongest internal culmination and its greatest external evidential vulnerability.

Why this earns marks

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Original 6* · 20 marks, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

- Establishes pluralism and realism before turning to epistemology.
- Derives humility through mati/śruta, standpoint analysis (nayavāda), qualified assertion (syādvāda) and sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī).
- States the circularity and verification objections in strong form.
- Gives the graded-knowledge and karmic-obstruction reply.
- Adds the sophisticated distinction between complete cognition and selective communication.
- Delivers a graded verdict separating logical compatibility from evidential proof.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Layer-placement note

All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice. It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The cross-sectarian standing of the *Tattvārthasūtra* supplies a common doctrinal grammar without erasing Śvetāmbara-Digambara differences. This matters methodologically: cite the text as a shared systematic anchor, but do not infer complete uniformity of canon or practice. Tīrthaṅkaras are perfected teachers rather than creators, so Jaina religious authority remains compatible with an uncreated cosmos.

The deeper philosophical architecture is reciprocal. Metaphysical many-sidedness explains epistemic partiality; epistemic discipline supports ethical non-violence in thought; ethical purification removes the karmic obstruction that prevents complete knowledge. Treating these as unrelated chapters misses the system's unity.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and comparisons

Contradiction objection: how can permanence and change belong to one real? The Jaina reply indexes them to different ontological dimensions: permanence belongs to substance, while origination and decay belong to modes. This anticipates the broader strategy of standpoint qualification.

Buddhist challenge: an enduring substrate may appear unnecessary if causal continuity explains identity. Jainism replies that change is intelligible as the change *of* something and that a real bearer better explains responsibility and liberation.

Advaita challenge: plurality may be only empirical appearance. Jainism treats difference, matter and individual souls as ultimately real; liberation does not dissolve numerical individuality.

Nyāya challenge: *dharma-dravya* and *adharma-dravya* look unparsimonious. The Jaina defence treats them as enabling media, not forces or moral properties. The hardest remaining burden is the interaction of conscious *conscious soul (jīva)* with material *pudgala*.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced evaluation

The Jaina inversion of ordinary terminology is a frequent source of error: strict *perception (pratyakṣa)* is independent of senses and mind, whereas ordinary sensory cognition is conventionally direct but philosophically mediated. This scheme supports non-absolutism because finite embodied knowledge is partial, not because objects are unreal.

The strongest external difficulty concerns higher cognition and omniscience. These states organise the system's account of complete truth, but they are difficult to verify from an ordinary standpoint. A second difficulty is circularity: complete knowledge validates the many-sided system, while the system explains why complete knowledge exists. The Jaina reply appeals to graded removal of obscuring action and moral consequence (karma), but the evidential burden remains.

Do not equate epistemic humility with universal scepticism. A standpoint is assessable by whether it captures a real aspect; not every claim is equally valid.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections and replies

Contradiction: "is" and "is not" cannot both be true. The Jaina reply is that they are never asserted in the same respect, relation, place and time. Qualification preserves rather than violates non-contradiction.

Redundancy: why exactly seven forms? They systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility without repeating a logical possibility.

Self-refutation: if all claims are conditional, is many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) itself merely conditional? The strongest Jaina reply distinguishes the minimal unconditional insight that finite unqualified predication is incomplete

from an exhaustive absolutist description of reality.

The omniscience cost: *perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna)* prevents the system from becoming total relativism, but its independent proof remains difficult. Thus Jainism is better classified as qualified or non-absolutist realism, not relativism in the sense that every opinion is equally true.

LINK: **2026 conceptual anchor:** recent public and educational discussions around Mahāvīra Jayanti again used *many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)* as a resource for dialogue amid polarization. This is an application analogy only, not evidence for the classical doctrine.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and ethical refinements

The distinctive strength of Jaina action and moral consequence (karma) theory is its integration of psychology, ethics and embodiment: *bhāvabandha* explains inner adhesiveness, while *dravyabandha* explains objective karmic continuity. Its deepest metaphysical weakness is interaction: how does material *pudgala* bind an intrinsically conscious soul?

Beginningless bondage avoids the need for a first moral fall, but creates another question: if the soul is naturally perfect, why is obscuration beginningless? Jainism answers operationally rather than historically-liberation requires removing present causes and accumulated matter.

The fourteen *guṇasthānas* make liberation gradual and technically ordered. The *sayoga-kevalī* stage is important because omniscience can occur while minimal embodied activity remains; final disembodied liberation follows later.

Sallekhanā must be analysed by intention, conditions and passionlessness. In its ideal doctrinal form it is a disciplined thinning of attachment at life's appropriate end, not impulsive self-destruction. Contemporary legal or medical claims require separate case-specific verification.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced dialectical verdict

Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja press the law of non-contradiction: a real cannot possess opposed attributes. The Jaina reply succeeds where predicates are explicitly indexed, but it still must explain the universal status of its own many-sided ontology.

Buddhist criticism challenges the permanent-yet-changing soul. Jainism gains moral agency and numerical continuity, while Buddhism gains ontological economy. Neither side wins without choosing a criterion-continuity, parsimony or explanatory adequacy.

Nyāya's interaction and extension objections expose a genuine pressure point. The lamp-light analogy makes bodily co-extension intelligible, but does not fully explain material action and moral consequence (karma)'s contact with consciousness.

Cārvāka's evidential challenge is strongest against higher cognition and liberation. Jaina internal coherence is not by itself external verification. The defensible final classification is **pluralistic, realistic and non-absolutist**, with acknowledged burdens concerning omniscience, soul-matter interaction and reflexive qualification.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The safest overall verdict is **qualified realism**. Jainism is realist because substances, souls, matter and modes exist independently of our descriptions. It is pluralist because no single substance or consciousness absorbs the rest. It is non-absolutist because finite predication captures aspects rather than the exhaustive whole.

Its achievement is architectural: permanence and change, truth and humility, agency and embodiment, ethics and liberation are integrated in one system. Its costs are equally systematic: taxonomy can become heavy; omniscience is difficult to verify; karmic matter creates an interaction problem; and the doctrine must reserve enough unconditional truth to state its own non-absolutism.

The final answer should never conclude "all viewpoints are true". The stronger conclusion is that viewpoints are conditionally valid when they track objective aspects and become false when absolutised.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

A. System identity

- Printed syllabus: theory of reality; *saptabhaṅgīnaya*; bondage and liberation.
- Shared textual anchor: Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī's *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Non-creator framework; Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers.
- Path: right vision, right knowledge and right conduct.

B. Reality

- *Sat* possesses *utpāda*, *vyaya* and *dhrauvya*.
- Substance persists while modes originate and cease.
- Six *substance (dravyas)*: conscious soul (*jīva*), pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla.
- Five are *astikāyas*; time is a substance (*dravya*) but not an *astikāya*.

C. Substance and soul

- Every substance (*dravya*) has abiding *qualities (guṇas)* and changing *pariyāyas*.
- Many conscious soul (*jīvas*) are real, beginningless and intrinsically conscious.
- Pudgala includes bodies, sense objects and karmic matter.
- Dharma/adharma are media of motion/rest, not merit/demerit.

D. Knowledge

- Strict Jaina *perception (pratyakṣa)* is unmediated soul-direct knowledge.
- Mati and śruta are mediated; avadhi, manañḥpariyāya and kevala are strictly direct.
- Ordinary cognition is karmically partial.
- Perfect knowledge (kevala-jñāna) is complete, unobstructed knowledge.

E. Many-sided judgement

- *Many-sided reality (anekāntavāda)*: objective many-sidedness.
- *Naya*: legitimate partial standpoint.
- *Syāt*: "in some respect," preventing absolutisation.
- Partial truth becomes error when presented as exhaustive.

F. Sevenfold predication

1. somehow it is;
2. somehow it is not;
3. somehow it is and is not;
4. somehow it is inexpressible;
5. somehow it is and is inexpressible;
6. somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
7. somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

Opposites are indexed to substance, place, time and mode; *avaktavya* is not mere ignorance.

G. Absolutism objection

- Critic: universal non-absolutism seems self-defeating.
- Reply: objective many-sidedness grounds conditional finite claims.
- Omniscience supplies a complete standpoint within the system.
- Residual burden: justify omniscience and the doctrine's own universal reach.

H. Action and moral consequence (karma) and bondage

- Action and moral consequence (karma) is subtle material *pudgala*.
- Activity brings influx; passion fixes and intensifies it.
- Bhāvabandha is psychic bondage; dravyabandha is material adhesion.
- Four parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.

I. Liberation sequence

INFLUX OF KARMIC MATTER (āsrava) -> BONDAGE (bandha) -> STOPPAGE OF KARMIC INFLUX (saṃvara) -> SHEDDING OF ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma) (nirjarā) -> LIBERATION (mokṣa)

- Stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara) stops new action and moral consequence (karma); shedding of action and moral consequence (karma) (nirjarā) removes old action and moral consequence (karma).
- Liberation is subtraction of obstruction, not merger or annihilation.
- The siddha remains an individual omniscient soul.

J. Ethics and stages

- Five vows: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya and aparigraha.
- Seven principles (tattvas) become nine categories (padārthas) by adding puṇya and pāpa.
- Eight action and moral consequence (karma) types divide into ghātiyā and aghātiyā.
- Fourteen *guṇasthānas* culminate in sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī.

K. Criticism-reply grid

Critic	Pressure	Jaina reply
Śaṅkara/Rāmānuja	contradiction	different respects and modes
Buddhist	permanence plus change	substance (dravya) persists; mode (paryāya) changes
Nyāya	soul-matter interaction	conscious soul (jīva) has pradeśas; karmic matter is subtle
Empiricist	omniscience unverifiable	inference, testimony and system coherence

L. Final answer discipline

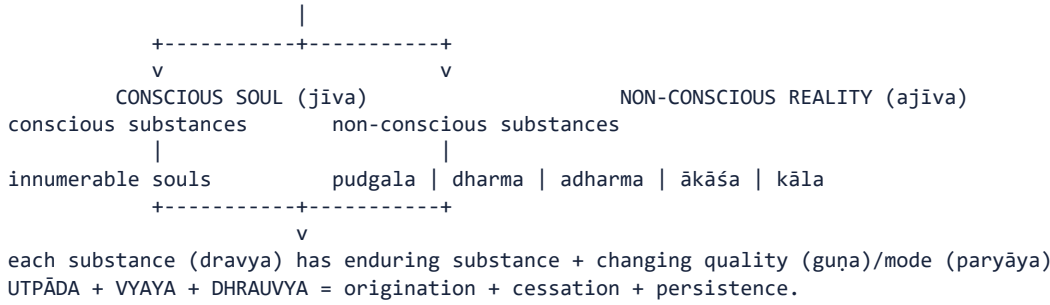
1. Identify the exact syllabus limb.
2. Define terms before listing classifications.
3. Link reality to judgement or action and moral consequence (karma) to liberation.
4. Preserve ordered sequences exactly.
5. State one named objection and the Jaina reply.
6. Distinguish internal coherence from external proof.
7. Conclude with qualified realism, not "all views are true."

Final judgement: Jainism achieves a powerful integration of permanence and change, realism and humility, and ethics and liberation; its hardest costs are the material soul-action and moral consequence (karma) interaction and the epistemic burden of omniscience.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/8: Plural realist ontology

JAIN REALITY (SAT) = permanence-through-change



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/8: Conscious soul (jīva) and non-conscious reality (ajīva) mechanics

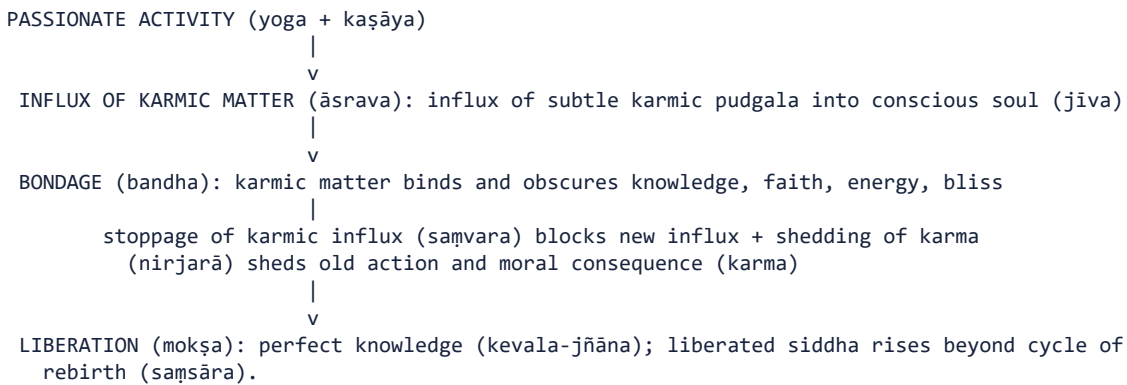
CONSCIOUS SOUL (jīva): consciousness (upayoga) is essential; knowledge is naturally unbounded embodied state -> soul expands/contracts to body -> agency + experience

NON-CONSCIOUS REALITY (ajīva) FIVEFOLD

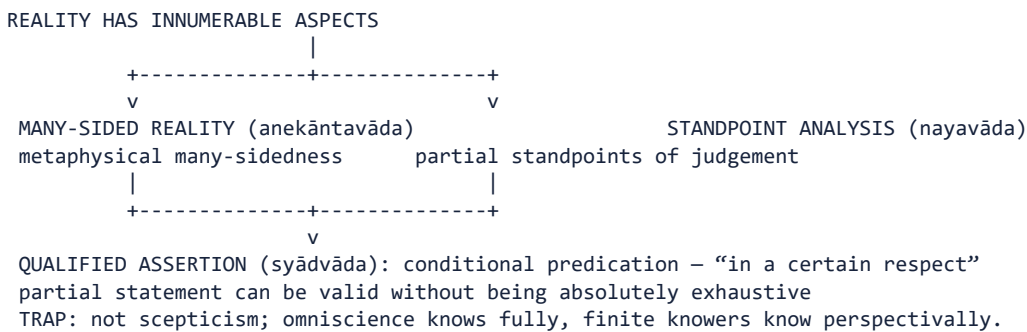
pudgala = matter, including karmic matter | ākāśa = accommodation
dharma = medium of motion | adharma = medium of rest
kāla = condition of change

TRAP: dharma/adharma here are cosmic media, not moral merit/demerit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/8: Bondage as material process



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/8: Many-sided knowledge



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/8: Sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī) sevenfold branch

ABOUT OBJECT X, UNDER SPECIFIED STANDPOINT / TIME / MODE:

- 1 syād-asti -> in some respect, X is
 - 2 syān-nāsti -> in some respect, X is not
 - 3 syād-asti-nāsti -> successively, X is and is not
 - 4 syād-avaktavyaḥ -> X is inexpressible under simultaneous demand
 - 5 syād-asti-avaktavyaḥ -> X is and is inexpressible
 - 6 syān-nāsti-avaktavyaḥ -> X is not and is inexpressible
 - 7 syād-asti-nāsti-avaktavyaḥ -> X is, is not, and is inexpressible
- CONTRADICTION IS AVOIDED BY DIFFERENT RESPECTS, NOT BY ASSERTING P AND NOT-P SIMPLY.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/8: Ethical-soteriological route

SAMYAG-DARŚANA -> SAMYAG-JÑĀNA -> SAMYAK-CĀRITRA

right faith right knowledge right conduct

|
five vows: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya,
brahmacarya, aparigraha
|

householder aṇuvrata -> ascetic mahāvratā -> guṇasthāna purification

|
ahiṃsā disciplines body, speech and thought because every conscious soul (jīva) can be harmed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/8: Objections, replies, comparisons

OBJECTION

JAIN REPLY

qualified assertion (syādvāda) is self-refuting it applies conditionally to itself, not absolutely

seven forms are repetitive combinations track affirmation, denial, ineffability

many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) destroys truth it rejects one-sided absolutism, not determinate truth

karma-matter/soul contact obscure bondage is beginningless via passions and subtle pudgala

|
BUDDHISM: change without substance | VEDĀNTA: unity beneath plurality
JAINISM: real substances persist through real modes; plurality is irreducible.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/8: PYQ answer architecture

OPEN: Jainism joins realism, pluralism and perspectival discipline

|
ontology -> conscious soul (jīva)/non-conscious reality (ajīva) -> dravya-guṇa-paryāya ->
permanence-through-change
|

epistemology -> many-sided reality (anekāntavāda) -> naya -> syāt -> exact seven bhaṅgas

|
soteriology -> action and moral consequence (karma) as matter -> influx of karmic matter
(āsrava)/bondage (bandha) -> stoppage of karmic influx (saṃvara)/shedding of karma (nirjarā)
-> liberation (mokṣa)
|

evaluate strongest contradiction objection and standpoint reply

|
CLOSE: qualified predication protects complexity without surrendering truth.